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From the Banquet to the Border: The Transformation of Su Shi's Song Lyrics into a Poetry of National Loss in the Restoration Era

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This article examines the historical process through which early Southern Song writers transformed Su Shi's song lyrics on exile and displacement into a national poetry of loss in which geography became a new object of longing. While Su Shi's song lyric innovations were often not well received during the late Northern Song, the experience of dynastic dislocation after 1127 caused his song lyrics to become urgent and compelling. By appropriating different aspects of Su Shi's song lyrics, early Southern Song writers initiated a new song lyric style whose spatial focus had shifted from the banquet to an obsession with the border.

This essay examines how the crisis of the collapse of the Northern Song in 1126-1127 and the resulting flight of many refugees to southern China spurred an immediate upsurge of interest by both court and literati in literary legacy Su Shi 蘇軾 (1037-1101), leading to a revival of his song lyric (*ci* 詞) style. Su Shi was an innovator in several aesthetic fields including *shi* poetry, song lyrics, calligraphy, and painting during the 11th century.¹ His major contribution to the song lyric genre was to

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¹ For Su Shi's diverse literary, aesthetic, and philosophical accomplishments during the Northern Song see Ronald Egan, *Word, Image, and Deed in the Life of Su Shi*. Cambridge: Harvard University Press, 1994 and Michael Fuller, *The Road to East Slope, The Development of Su Shi's Poetic Voice*. Stanford: Stanford University Press, 1990. For the relationship between Su Shi's poetry, contemporary politics, and his periods of exile see Charles Hartman, "Poetry and Politics in 1079: The Crow Terrace Poetry Case of Su Shih," *CLEAR* 12 (1990): 15-44 and

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transform the romantic popular song form into a vehicle for expressing literati identity and the experience of geographic and social displacement. What had once been a genre defined primarily by popular songs expressing longing for a lover far away also became a vehicle for literati expressions of longing for places distant or lost. It was precisely this intersection between genre and geography that became the creative focus of a group of literati actively engaged in the restoration of the Southern Song dynasty during the period of the 1130's and 1140's. During the late Northern Song, Su Shi's song lyric innovations were often not well-received; both for the way they departed from the expectations of an oral-performative banquet setting and due to the hostile political environment of the Huizong administration which attempted to ban the circulation of Su Shi's literary works. By contrast, the experience and emotions generated by dynastic dislocation after 1127 shaped the reception of Su Shi's literary legacy and caused Su Shi's introduction of geography into the song lyric to become all the more urgent and compelling. For early Southern Song literati Su Shi's innovations with the song lyric in the 11th century offered new possibilities by introducing geography as a potential object of longing for this romantic genre. By appropriating different aspects of Su Shi's song lyrics, these early Southern Song writers initiated a new song lyric style whose spatial focus had shifted from the banquet to an obsession with the border. It was a return to the theme of romance in a new form. Geography itself had become the new potential object of longing in the song lyric genre in a literary project by these writers to transform Su Shi's individual song lyrics on exile and displacement into a national poetry of loss.

This paper examines the adaptations of Su Shi's song lyric style during the transitional period between 1126 and 1148 by three writers: Wang Yining 王以寧 (1090?-1146?), Zhang Yuangan 張元幹 (1093-1161), and Ye Mengde 葉夢得 (1077-1148). While diverse in terms of their geographic origins, official rank, and age, they all shared at least two traits. First, they all belonged to a broadly defined social and political circle centered on the figure of Li Gang 李綱 (1083-1140), the first prime minister of Emperor Gaozong's administration (r.1127-1162) during a time of mass displacement and rapidly shifting borders. For a remarkably brief tenure of 75 days, Li Gang served as the able crisis manager of the court in its flight south, overseeing the court's relocation from the north to Yangzhou during the years 1127-1128. After the court's initial relocation to Yingtian fu outside the occupied capital, Gaozong was declared emperor in a hasty coronation and the first of three court debates on the proper siting of a new capital for a restored dynasty began. The then prime minister Li Gang made his "three capitals" proposal with the aim of eventually recovering Kaifeng, but soon was demoted due to his vocal advocacy for a more aggressive response to the Jin invasion and his opposition to the humiliating terms of the peace

Kathleen Tomlonovic, "Poetry of Exile and Return: A Study of Su Shi (1037-1101)" Ph.D. Dissertation, University of Washington, 1989.

treaty proposed with the Jin dynasty.² This debate and the movement of the court continued into the Shaoxing reign (1131-1162) or “Restoration Era,” ending only in 1138 when Gaozong returned to Hangzhou and the future border between the Song and Jin dynasties took shape along the Huai River. Although the imperial house’s “temporary residence” at Hangzhou turned out to be permanent for over a century, the debate over lost territories and changed borders continued in an outpouring of writings on place and boundaries during the 1130’s and 1140’s. These three song lyric writers shared Li Gang’s concern for the loss of the north, served as military commissioners directly under Li Gang or independently during the period of crisis, and used the song lyric to describe the changed landscape and shifting borders of the “Restoration Era.”

Second, all three writers had direct connections to the literary legacy of Su Shi and showed a keen interest in exploiting and elaborating the discourse on longing for place that he introduced to the song lyric. In particular, these early Southern Song literati emphasized the new functions of collective remembrance and political remonstrance for the song lyric, in part by adapting a central trope from the song lyrics of Su Shi which I term “imagined travel” or *shenyou* 神游. Not only do we see a new and profound obsession with shifting geographic borders in their song lyrics, but on a broader level we also see a shifting of literary borders, as writers and critics of the “Restoration Era” used different strategies to raise the generic status of the song lyric. This paper will explore this process of literary adaptation and revival in three parts. First, I examine two of song lyrics Su Shi that highlight those innovations in the genre during the 11th century that had the greatest impact on his 12th century interpreters. Second, I examine the history of the circulation and criticism of Su Shi’s song lyrics from the late Northern Song to the early Southern Song to demonstrate a positive change in their critical reception by early Southern Song literati. Third, I will introduce and analyze key song lyrics composed by these three transitional writers from the early Southern Song, to show the spatial shift from the banquet to the border in their song lyrics and the way their interpretations of Su Shi’s song lyric style established a new literary model that would influence later generations.

Part I: Exile and Longed-for Landscapes *“Imagined Travel” in the Song Lyrics of Su Shi*

² For a Southern Song historian’s account of the courts movements during the early Southern Song, see Li Xinchuan’s “A Full Account of Establishing the Capital during the Restoration” (中興定都本末) in Li Xinchuan, Xu Gui annot., *Jianyan yilai chaoye zaji* (Beijing: Zhonghua shuju, 2006): 119. For a summary of the court debates on the siting of the capital of the Southern Song by a modern historian, see Lin Zhengqiu, 林正秋. *Nansong ducheng lin’an* 南宋都城臨安 *Lin’an: Capital of the Southern Song* (Shanghai: Xileng yinshe chuban, 1986): 24-37.

Below I examine two of Su Shi's song lyrics from his exile periods that highlight features which became particularly compelling for early Southern Song literati. The first important stylistic trait of Su Shi's song lyrics that rose to prominence during the early Southern Song was the association he established between his song lyrics and the experience of political and geographic displacement. Su Shi left behind a considerable body of song lyrics written while in exile. In fact Su Shi's most prolific period of song lyric writing occurred during his five year exile in Huangzhou from 1080 to 1084.³ During this time and in later years Su Shi developed a new kind of song lyric style that sought to address the experience of displacement in exile. In part, this involved importing a theme from classical *shi* poetry on "contemplating the past" (*huaigu shi* 懷古詩) that figured prominently in poetry of the Tang dynasty. In poems dedicated to this theme, the poet recalls historical figures that are associated with some physical trace in the landscape. These traces in the landscape serve as shared cues between the poet and his audience. Frequently in such poems, the poet first "ascends a height for a distant view" (*denglin* 登臨 or *denggao wangyuan* 登高望遠), a standard topos which links the vast geographic distance of the poet's view with the long temporal distance of his historical reveries.⁴ At the same, Su Shi combined this theme with the trope of "imagined travel" or *shenyou* 神游, a poetic device that reflects his personal and philosophical interest in the meaning of dreams. In this trope reflections on historical figures are likened to dream journeys or "flights of the imagination" into the past. Typically, Su Shi's song lyrics on "imagined travel" are written in the *manci* or "long song lyric" subgenre that are divided into two or more stanzas. Formally the trope of "imagined travel" involved the artful manipulation of the two stanzas in which one stanza describes travel through vast landscapes and a second stanza recalls historical figures, seeking to construct continuities between historical figures of the past and literati of the present. The act of recalling and

³ During his exile in Huangzhou, Su Shi wrote the single largest number of song lyrics compared to any other period of his life and a corresponding fewer number of *shi* poems. Of Su Shi's 331 extant song lyrics, 292 are datable. The vast majority of these were written while Su Shi was serving in or traveling to provincial appointments, and the greatest number for a single period (97 song lyrics or 33% of his total datable song lyrics) were written during Su Shi's first period of exile in Huangzhou (1080-1085). This indicates a trend in Su Shi's composition of song lyrics toward using them to write about the problems of displacement while he was removed from the political center. See Zou Tongqing and Wang Zongtang, *Sushi ci bianninan jiaozhu*, 140-270 and 272-563.

⁴ Liao Weiqing's study of this theme has demonstrated, "contemplating the past" began to appear as an important topic in rhapsodies (*fu* 賦) of the early 3rd century and later became popularized in *shi* poetry of the Tang dynasty by the 7th century. See Liao Weiqing 廖蔚卿, *Han Wei Liuchao wenxue lunji* 漢魏六朝文學論集 *Collection of Essays on Literature of the Han, Wei, and Six Dynasties* (Taipei: Da'an chubanshe, 1997): 56-71. For the popularity of this topos in Tang dynasty *shi* poetry see Hans Frankel "The Contemplation of the Past in T'ang Poetry" in Denis Twitchett and Arthur F. Wright, eds. *Perspectives on the T'ang*. (New Haven: Yale University Press, 1973): 345-365.

reenacting the past in the transition between the first and second stanzas, is often described as a dream-like process in which the “daimon” or “spirit” (神 *shen*) travels outward from the body into memories of the past. As will be further demonstrated below, using the trope of “imagined travel” Su Shi established a bond of sympathetic identification between himself and historical figures of the past and further “sentimentalized” those landscapes associated with heroic figures of the past.

First, let us turn to one of Su Shi’s most famous song lyrics, set to the tune of “The Charms of Niannu” 念奴嬌 that demonstrates this process of sentimentalizing landscapes. In this song lyric Su Shi recalls the heroic victory of Zhou Yu 周瑜 (175-210) of the Wu kingdom over the navy of the Wei kingdom led by Cao Cao 曹操 (155-220) at the Battle of the Red Cliff in 208 CE. The Three Kingdoms period covered a turbulent half-century that saw the fall of the Han dynasty, the subsequent division of the empire into three kingdoms— Wei, Wu, and Shu— in 220 CE, and the reunification of the realm in AD 280 under a new ruling house, the Jin. The period was remembered in history for the charismatic leaders of each of the Three Kingdoms and the areas that they dominated, their efforts to recruit the most talented advisors from the scholar-officials scattered after the demise of the Han court, and the strategies or alliances used by each kingdom to outwit and overcome the others. For public-minded Northern Song literati, like Su Shi, this period of intense geo-political competition must have seemed like a mirror to their own age. The geography of the Yangzi river delta, where the Three Kingdoms intersected and many of the most important battles of the period took place, therefore offered up a rich symbolic language of landscape and national politics. In Su Shi’s reverie of this epic battle we can see how the poet closely identifies with the figure of Zhou Yu and transferred the kind of romantic sentiment typically associated with the banquet setting to the landscape and heroic figures of the past. As is common in Su Shi’s song lyrics on historical reflection, physical travel in landscape in one stanza is often paralleled by mental travel through memory into the past in a second stanza.

念奴嬌
赤壁懷古

大江東去，
浪淘盡，
千古風流人物。
故壘西邊，
人道是，三國周郎赤壁。

亂石崩雲，
驚濤裂岸，
捲起千堆雪。
江山如畫，
一時多少豪傑。

“The Charms of Niannu”
“Cherishing the Past” at the Red Cliff

The Great River flows to the east:
Its waves have washed away
All the men of untrammelled spirit of a thousand ages.
To the west of the ancient ramparts,
They say is the Red Cliff of young Zhou of the Three
Kingdoms.
Random rocks break through the clouds,
Startling billows shatter the banks,
Rolling up a thousand heaps of snow.
The river and the mountains are like a painting-
At one time, how many heroes there were!

遙想公瑾當年，
小喬初嫁了，
雄姿英發。
羽扇綸巾，
談笑間，強虜灰飛煙滅。

故國神游，
多情應笑我，
早生華髮。
人間如夢，
一尊還酹江月。⁵

Imagine Lord Zhou as he was, so long ago,
When the Younger Qiao had just married him:
His brilliant wit and manly air!
Feather fan in hand, silk-turbaned,
Amid talk and laughter, he turned the powerful enemy
into
flying ashes and vanishing smoke.
As my spirit wanders to the ancient kingdom,
You may well laugh at me for being so sentimental,
And growing gray hair so soon!
Human life is like a dream-
Still, let me pour a libation to the river moon!⁶

The dominant theme in the first stanza is the transience of historical heroes in the face of the overwhelming power of nature to wash away all traces of the past, conveyed by the opening images of the crashing waves of the Yangzi River. The opening tone of the song lyric is one of lament and longing “ubi sunt,” asking, “where are those who were before us?”

Su Shi marks the transition from present view of the landscape in the first stanza to a journey into memory in the second stanza with the words “distantly imagining” (*yaoxiang* 遙想). As we shall see, in a homage to the literary model provided by Su Shi, early Southern Song literati also frequently employed verbs denoting “distantly imagining,” “cherishing the past” or “pursuing the past is like a dream” to signal the transition from physical to imagined travel in the second stanzas of their song lyrics. The object of Su Shi’s “imagined travel” into the past is none other than Zhou Yu, the young general of the Kingdom of Wu who defeated Cao Cao’s navy at the Battle of Red Cliff. Three aspects of Su Shi’s depiction of Zhou Yu are important to consider. The first is Zhou Yu’s youth and romantic virility, portrayed in the first strophe of the second stanza that describes his recent marriage to the “Younger Qiao” and his “brilliant wit and manly air.” Imaginary flights in Liu Yong’s 柳永 (987-1053) *manzi* typically depict a return to the traveler persona’s youth and his romantic attachment to a lover in the city. Like Liu Yong, Su Shi’s imaginary return to the past is nostalgic return to youth, one imbued with romantic sentiment through his inclusion of Zhou Yu’s wife Xiao Qiao. A second quality Su Shi highlights in his depiction of Zhou Yu is his unperturbed state of mind at the height of a daring strategic defense. History recorded that Zhou Yu possessed great musical talent and a keen ear that could discriminate tones just as well as it could distinguish true words from cunning

⁵ Zou Tongqing and Wang Zongtang, *Sushi ci bianninan jiaozhu*, 398-410.

⁶ Here I have modified the translation by James Liu, *Major Lyricists of the Northern Song* (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1974): 139-140.

deception.⁷ Zhou Yu's musical talent makes him an appropriate object of recollection in the song lyric genre which often describes musical performances, contemporary or historical. Third, Zhou Yu, a military leader is depicted by Su Shi as a scholar, holding a "feather fan" and wearing a "silk turban." Su Shi's portrait of Zhou Yu as a civilian scholar with a romantic character and musical talent illustrate the poet's close identification with this historical figure, especially as one of the first Northern Song literati to adapt the romantic song lyric genre as a vehicle for expressing literati identity.

Significantly, in the second stanza of "The Charms of Niannu," Su Shi introduces the key concept *shenyou* 神游 or "imagined travel." As Shuen-fu Lin has discussed in his studies of the theme of dreams in the song lyric genre, the term "*shen you*" or "roaming of the daimon" as he translates it, derives from the idea in traditional Chinese dream theory that during sleep the body is closed off and the soul or spirit can go wandering away from its abode, the body, to encounter the spirits of other people or other things.⁸ Pre-modern scholars and writers later adapted this idea of the spirit's flight outside the body while dreaming to describe processes of sensory perception, memory, and literary creation that take place within the mind. Most prominently, the Six Dynasties literary critic, Liu Xie 劉勰 (465-521), theorized that one of the first stages in the process of literary creation was the "roaming of the daimon" in which one's spirit roamed within one's mind where it could freely encounter stored up memories or "images of things" (*wuxiang* 物象). These "images of things," derived from one's sensory impressions or acquired book knowledge, form the material which would be consciously shaped and crafted in later stages of the process of literary creation.⁹ In the final two strophes of "The Charms of Niannu" we can see reference to the trope of memory being likened to a "roaming of the daimon" when Su Shi states "my spirit wanders the ancient kingdom." Significantly, Su Shi specifies the destination of his wandering spirit in memory as an "ancient kingdom" (*guguo* 故國), a term that can mean the landscape or territory of a kingdom of the past or to the capital city of that kingdom. By doing so Su Shi explicitly links the landscape of the Red Cliff and its historical associations with a kind of romantic

⁷ In his short essay on "Zhou Yu's Cultivated Tolerance" (*Zhou Yu yaliang* 周瑜雅量) Su Shi retells a historical anecdote in which Zhou Yu's musical talents allowed him to outwit an itinerant persuader sent to him by Cao Cao. See Kong Fanli 孔凡禮, ed. *Su Shi wenji* 蘇軾文集 *Su Shi's Collected Prose* vol.5 (Beijing: Zhonghua shuju, 1996): 2020. The close identification of Zhou Yu with musical talent can be seen in the later formation of the short-hand, four-character phrase "Zhou who pays attention to the tune" (*zhoulang guqu* 周郎顧曲).

⁸ Shuen-fu Lin, "Through a Window of Dreams: Reality and Illusion in the Song Lyrics of the Song Dynasty" in Grace S. Fong, ed., *Hsiang Lectures on Chinese Poetry*. (Montreal: McGill University Center for East Asian Research, 2001): 20-24.

⁹ See Shuen-fu Lin, "Liu Xie on Imagination" in Zong-qi Cai, ed., *A Chinese Literary Mind: Culture, Creativity, and Rhetoric in Wenxin Diaolong* (Stanford: Stanford University Press, 2001): 140-146.

sentiment. Given that “daimon” or “spirit” (*shen* 神) represents the subjective mental capacities of a person, the second character in this term, “roaming” (*you* 游) can be understood in this song lyrics as an uprooting of the subject from its environment and a movement outward. This movement is aimed toward different kinds of landscape, representing larger collective wholes. Through the trope of “imagined travel” in the *manzi* by Su Shi and his later Southern Song interpreters we can see the constant negotiation between individual subjectivities and larger imagined communities.

Two other feature of Su Shi’s song lyrics are important to consider here for their reception during the early Southern Song. These are the ways in which he began to expand the functions of the genre beyond banquet entertainment to include political persuasion and to narrow the focus of the intended audience for his song lyrics onto a community of like-minded literati. In part he accomplished this through the greater use of prefaces to his song lyrics that stabilized the interpretation of his song lyrics within the narrative of his life and exiles.¹⁰ Su Shi also began writing song lyrics addressed to specific individuals that were exchanged in a group setting in person or across distances and often written to matching rhymes. The following song lyric, set to the tune of “The Delight of Returning to Court” 歸朝歡, is a clear example of Su Shi’s use of a matching-rhyme song lyrics written in exchange with a colleague intended to establish a sense of collective identity and continuity between literati of the Northern Song dynasty and certain historical figures of the past. This song lyric was written in 1094 when Su Shi was 59 years old, when he was sent into exile for the second time in his life and confronted the prospect of becoming a permanent sojourner or *ke* 客.¹¹ This song lyric, set to the somewhat ironically chosen tune title “The Delight of Returning to Court” was written when Su Shi arrived at the town of Jiujiang 九江 midway through his journey by boat into exile. Here he met his junior colleague, Su Jian 蘇堅 (style-name *bogu* 伯固, no family relationship to Su Shi). In a very short preface Su Shi stated that his song lyric was as a matching-rhyme piece written in response to a first song lyric composed by Su Jian, now lost. Su Shi used this song lyric as a kind of travel diary to record and to interpret his second journey into exile. Both scholar-officials had been demoted and were departing from this point in central China to regions further in the south: Su Jian to Liyang 澧陽 (in modern-day Hunan province) and Su Shi to the even more distant region of Huizhou 惠州 (in

¹⁰ Su Shi added prefaces to over 43 % of his song lyrics, allowing him to shape the way his song lyrics were transmitted and interpreted, grounding them in the specific times and places of his biography and directing them toward a more narrowly defined literati audience.

¹¹ During a period when the Yuanyou political faction he was associated with was in favor with the Empress Dowager Xuanren 宣仁太后, Su Shi was active in the administrative capital of Kaifeng (1087-1089) and in the cultural center of Hangzhou (1090-1093). Throughout this period Su Shi was attacked by political opponents in the Censorate Bureau, but these had little effect until the young emperor Zhezong 哲宗 (r. 1086-1100) took direct control of the government in 1093 and, seeking to restore the policies and officials of his father’s administration, sent Su Shi and many of his colleagues into political exile in regions of southern China.

modern-day Guangzhou). In describing their common physical and political displacement in this song lyric, Su Shi evokes the collective experience of many Northern Song scholar-officials in the late 11th century. At the same time he attempts to derive a strategy for the scholar-official to maintain his social identity in exile by linking the present situation to past historical figures.

歸朝歡
和蘇監伯固

“The Delight of Returning to Court”
Matching rhymes with Su Jian, Bogu

我夢扁舟浮震澤。
雪浪搖空千頃白。
覺來滿眼是廬山，
倚天無數開青壁。

I dreamt of a flat-bottomed boat floating on Zhen Marsh.
Snowy waves rock the skies, a thousand acres of white.
Waking up, the sight of Lu Mountain fills my eyes,
Leaning on heaven, its countless green cliffs open up
before me.

此生長接淅。
與君同是江南客。
夢中游，
覺來清賞，
同作飛梭擲。

This life is a constant bustle.
You and I are alike sojourners in the South.
In dreams we wander,
Waking we appreciate pure scenes,
Alike we’re thrown about like flying weaving shuttles.

明日西風還掛席。
唱我新詞淚沾臆。
靈均去後楚山空，
澧陽蘭芷無顏色。
君才如夢得。
武陵更在西南極。
竹枝詞，
莫搖新唱，
誰謂古今隔。¹²

Tomorrow we will set sail again with the Western wind.
Singing my new lyric causes tears to fill my breast.
After Lingjun departed, the mountains of Chu were empty,
And the angelicas and orchids of Liyang lost their color.
Your talent is like Mengde’s.
Wuling lies even further in the Southwest.
The “Bamboo Branch Lyrics”
Are still sung by the Moyao people,
Who says that past and present are divided?

In the first stanza, Su Shi views the landscape of the present and depicts the journey as a series of fragmented moments, while also asserting his solidarity with his fellow exiled scholar-official colleague, Su Jian. He compares the journey into exile to the disjunction felt between what one experiences in a dream and what one finds in waking life. The dream of floating on a boat refers to the famous Lake Tai 太湖 nearby Hangzhou, where Su Shi had served for three years prior to his sudden demotions and where his journey into exile began, while Mt. Lu 廬山 represents the location where Su Shi had just arrived, further up-river on the Yangzi at Jiujiang. The abrupt transition from Hangzhou to Jiu Jiang is likened to suddenly awakening from a pleasant dream and not knowing where one is, conveyed by the irreconcilable images of being surrounded first by water (towering white waves) and then by mountains (towering green cliffs). At the same time, Su Shi asserts his solidarity with

¹² Zou Tongqing and Wang Zongtang, *Sushi ci biannian jiaozhu*, 737.

Su Jian, by using the adverb “alike” twice in this stanza: Su Shi first asserts his solidarity with Su Jian and then interprets his dream by stating that this kind of displacement is the common condition of men of their class. The weaving shuttle metaphor aptly encapsulates the lack of agency Su Shi experiences in his journey into exile. They are the shuttle another hand moves: while he enjoys the freedom to “wander” in dreams, in waking life he cannot linger to appreciate “pure scenes,” but is continually shuttled involuntarily from place to place.

In the second stanza Su Shi counters the displacement of exile with continuities he constructs between himself and his colleague Su Jian with historical figures of the past in an act of “imagined travel.” Here Su Shi compares his colleague to two historical figures, the 4th century B.C.E. banished minister Qu Yuan 屈原 (ca. 340-278 B.C.E.) and the exiled official of the Mid-Tang dynasty Liu Yuxi 劉禹錫 (772-842 CE). Su Shi linked himself and Su Jian to these historical figures based on the idea of reenactment. He groups these two historical figures together on the basis of their common putative collecting and editing of local folk songs from the area in which they lived while in exile and the beneficial impact each figure had on the local people even while in exile. Both of these figures were also associated with the place that Su Jian was destined for, the area of the ancient kingdom of Chu (in modern-day western Hunan province). A legend held that while in exile the ancient banished minister Qu Yuan (whose style name was Lingjun 靈均) had sought distraction from his grief in the rustic songs of the local people dedicated to shamanistic rituals to the gods. Finding the words of local songs too “crude,” Qu Yuan improved on this oral tradition by writing new lyrics to the songs. This is the legendary origin of the canonical “Nine Songs” now found in the anthology *Songs of the South* or *Chu Ci* 楚辭.¹³ Many centuries later, the political reformer Liu Yuxi was exiled to the town of Wuling located in this region. During his ten-year stay in Wuling 武陵, Liu Yuxi wrote his “Bamboo Lyrics” based on the local folk songs he enjoyed there, consciously referring to the legend about Qu Yuan’s editing of local songs in a preface to these works.¹⁴ Su Shi’s closes the song lyric with a direct address to the reader and the rhetorical question, “who says that the past and present are divided.” Su Shi compares the talent of Su Jian to Liu Yuxi (whose style name was Mengde 夢得, no relation to Ye Mengde) and suggests that with Su Jian’s travel to Liyang he too will continue this tradition and create new lyrics to the local folk music. The maintenance of scholar-official identity under the condition of exile then appears in the form of the relationship between exiled official and the local people, as the memory (and perhaps the deeds) of the former is continued and transmitted through the singing of these new songs by the local people. This is the positive promise Su Shi holds out when he writes that the indigenous

¹³ David Hawkes, trans., *The Songs of the South:—An Ancient Chinese Anthology of Poems by Qu Yuan and Other Poets* (London: Penguin Books, 1985): 96-97.

¹⁴ See Bian Xiaoxuan 卞孝萱, ed. *Liu Yuxi ji* 劉禹錫集 *The Collected Works of Liu Yuxi* vol.2 (Beijing: Zhonghua shuju, 1990): 359.

Moyao people of Wuling still sing the “Bamboo Lyrics” of Liu Yuxi. While this piece of poetic persuasion may strike modern readers as somewhat wishful thinking on Su Shi’s part, it is important to point out that, just as in “The Charms of Niannu” examined above, here again Su Shi invests the local landscape of exile with sentiment in his song lyric. The landscape of exile, traditionally a place of punishment and alienation in the Chinese poetic tradition, has once again in Su Shi’s literary works been “overturned” (*fan* 反) into an object of longing and a place of connection with the local people. Su Shi’s introduction of landscape as a potential object of longing in the song lyric would have a profound influence on his Southern Song interpreters.

Part II: From Performance to Print: The Legacy of Su Shi’s Song Lyrics in the Restoration Era

An overview of the history of the circulation of Su Shi’s song lyrics and song lyric criticism on them from the Northern Song to the early Southern Song demonstrates that while Su Shi’s song lyrics were not as well-received during his own lifetime, they became the basis for the development of one of the most important stylistic options for literati writing song lyrics during the “Restoration Era.” During the reigns of the last two emperors of the Northern Song, Zhezong (r. 1085-1100) and Huizong (r. 1100-1125), in parallel with the demotion and exile of officials associated with the Yuanyou party, a policy of proscribing the writings of Yuanyou officials known as the “Yuanyou factional proscriptions” was also instituted in a series of promulgations between the years 1102-1104.¹⁵ As the scholars Shen Songqin 沈松勤 and Uchiyama Seiya 內山精也 have noted, almost immediately following the military disaster of the sacking of Kaifeng, the literary proscription was lifted and Su Shi’s literary legacy underwent a dramatic reevaluation by Gaozong’s court that was later amplified by subsequent Southern Song emperors. One year after the loss of Kaifeng in 1128 Gaozong conferred the honorific posthumous title on Su Shi of Academician of the Duanming Hall (*duanmingdian xueshi* 端明殿學士), followed by the second title of Academician of the Hall for Assisting Government and Grand Master for Court Service (*zizhengdian xueshi* 資政殿學士, *chaofeng daifu* 朝奉大夫) in 1131 once the court had relocated in the south.¹⁶ The second emperor of the Southern Song, Xiaozong 孝宗 (r.1163-1189), likewise also sought to enhance the legitimacy of his reign by

¹⁵ On the “Yuanyou factional proscriptions” see Ari Levine, “Terms of Estrangement: Factional Discourse in the Early Huizong Reign” and John Chaffee, “Huizong, Cai Jing, and the Politics of Reform” in Patricia Ebrey and Maggie Bickford, ed., *Emperor Huizong and Late Northern Song China* (Cambridge: Harvard University Asia Center, 2006): 149-165 and 43-44 respectively.

¹⁶ See Li Xinchuan, 162-163 and Shen Songqin, 沈松勤. “Songshi nanduhou de ‘chongsure’ yu cixue mingyun” 宋室南渡後的‘崇蘇熱’與詞學命運, “The ‘Su Shi Fever’ and the Fate of the Study of Song Lyrics Following the Song Court’s Flight to the South”, *Wenxue pinglun* 文學評論 2 (2005): 16.

promoting the legacy of Su Shi through the bestowal of posthumous honors 1170 and 1179.¹⁷ As Shen Songqin has argued, clearly this change in Su Shi's treatment by the court was a symbolic move in the cultural field to indicate a clear departure from the New Laws administration of the past and to broadcast that a new policy was underway.

However, the court was not the only player in the cultural field to reassess the literary and political legacy of Su Shi. Indeed, at the same time that the court's reception of Su Shi's legacy made a dramatic shift, there was also a publication boom during the Shaoxing reign period of commentary editions for both Su Shi's *shi* poetry and, even more significantly, song lyrics. This boom represents an important shift in the transmission of song lyrics from the 11th to 12th centuries, from primarily by means of oral-performance to increasingly through print during the Southern Song. Uchiyama has noted that at least two commentary editions of Su Shi's *shi* poetry were published during the Shaoxing reign: *Collected Commentaries on Mr. East Slope's Poetry Collections, Volumes I and II* (*jizhu dongpo xiansheng shi qianhou ji* 集註東坡先生詩前後集) and *East Slope's Matching-Tao-Poems Explained* (*dongpo hetao shijie* 東坡和陶詩解) edited by Fu Gong 傅共.¹⁸ Bibliographies from the period also record two commentary editions for Su Shi's song lyrics: *Mr. East Slope's Long and Short Lines* (*dongpo xiansheng changduanju* 東坡先生長短句) edited by Zeng Zao 曾慥, no longer extant, and *East Slope's Song Lyrics Annotated* (*zhu dongpo ci* 註東坡詞) by Fu Gan 傅幹 (12th century), son of Fu Gong, originally published during the Shaoxing reign period and now only partially preserved in a later transcribed edition.¹⁹ The publication of these commentary editions indicates an upsurge of literati interest in Su Shi's literary legacy and the swift response in the literary marketplace to that demand among enterprising commercial publishers such as Fu Gong and his son. While such a publication boom was no doubt allowed and encouraged by the change in imperial reception, a closer look at song lyrics written during the early Southern Song modeled on Su Shi's style below will show that the appropriation of Su Shi's literary legacy by early Southern Song literati was at best parallel to court actions and frequently, in the case of song lyrics, critical of court policy. It is this corpus of printed song lyrics that would define

¹⁷ Uchiyama Seiya 內山精也, " *Dongpo wutai shian liuchuan kao—weirao beisongmo zhi nansongchu shidaifu jian de Sushi wenyi zuopin zhoushire*" <<東坡烏台詩案>> 流傳考—圍繞北宋末至南宋初士大夫間的蘇軾文藝作品收集熱 "An Investigation into the Circulation of *Crow Terrace Poetry Case of Dongpo*—Regarding the Fever for Collecting Su Shi's Literary Works among Literati of the Late Northern Song and Early Southern Song" in Uchiyama Seiya, *Chuanmei yu zhenxiang—Su Shi ji qi zhouwei shidaifu de wenxue* 傳媒與真相—蘇軾及其周圍士大夫的文學 *Media and Reality—The Literature of Su Shi and His Literati Circle*. Zhu Gang 朱剛, trans. (Shanghai: Shanghai guji chubanshe, 2005): 164.

¹⁸ Uchiyama Seiya, 161-165.

¹⁹ Jao Tsung-I 饒宗頤, *Examination of Documents Relating to Tz'u, Ciji kao* 詞籍考 (Hong Kong: Hong Kong University Press, 1963): 46-48.

a new style in the eyes of early Southern Song literati who admired and imitated Su Shi's song lyrics.

The case of the two commentary editions of Su Shi's song lyrics has a special significance for the history of the early Southern Song reception and revival of Su Shi's literary legacy. During the Northern Song, as Ronald Egan has demonstrated, the generic status of song lyrics was still quite low and as a result they were as a rule not included in a literatus' collected literary works (*wenji* 文集).²⁰ Northern Song literati often expressed an ambivalent attitude toward the song lyric. *Ci* literally means "words," and as the name of a literary genre it refers to the words set to preexisting tunes that were sung in urban entertainment centers. The songs were performed by female entertainers—singing girls and courtesans of various social levels. For those with a bias against the genre, they were also treated at worst as potentially scandalous and damaging to one's moral reputation and at best as ephemeral products of the literati banquet or popular entertainment districts of the city. As a result, song lyrics were rarely carefully collected or recorded in writing, but instead were frequently transmitted far and wide orally in textually fluid versions as a living performance tradition, sometimes to the chagrin of their original authors.

By Su Shi's lifetime, the balance between oral and printed transmission of song lyrics had begun to shift slightly toward the latter as some separate collections began to circulate. The earliest record for the circulation of Su Shi's song lyrics in book form is the fragmentary Northern Song text of the *Collection of the Original Stories to the Tunes of Contemporary Worthies* (*shixian benshi quiz ji* 時賢本事曲子集) compiled by Su Shi's friend and colleague, Yang Yuansu 楊元素 (1017-1088). This text was composed of song lyric texts with "original stories" appended to them to provide the putative biographical context in which they were composed by the "Contemporary Worthies" of the time. From his personal letters, we know that Su Shi actively contributed to this collection during his exile in Huangzhou (1080-1084) and seems to have encouraged its circulation.²¹ As the term "tunes" (*quzi* 曲子) in the title suggests, the song lyric was still considered by Yang Yuansu and his contemporaries as primarily an oral-performative genre, but one whose authorial context (*benshi* 本事) was unstable and needed to be textually fixed in writing. By fixing the text of the song lyrics, aside their authorial contexts, literati could continue to enjoy composing song lyrics while also having a greater degree of control over the form and means of their circulation.

²⁰ Ronald Egan, "The Problem of the Repute of Tz'u During the Northern Sung" in Pauline Yu, ed., *Voices of the Song Lyric in China* (Berkeley: University of California Press, 1994): 192.

²¹ The *Collection of the Original Stories to the Tunes of Contemporary Worthies* contains entries on four song lyrics by Su Shi. See Tang Guizhang 唐圭璋, ed. *Cihua congbian* 詞話叢編 *Collected Song Lyric Chats*. Vol.1 (Beijing: Zhonghua shuju chubanshe, 1990): 8-10. For Su Shi's letters to Yang Yuansu on contributing material to this work, see "To Yang Yuansu" 與楊元素, #7 and #8 in Kong Fanli, ed. *Su Shi Wenji*, 1652-1653.

Song lyric collectors and publishers of the early Southern Song picked up on and greatly expanded the trends of putting song lyrics into print and thereby fixing them to particular authorial personae and styles that were only nascent in Yang Yuansu's 11th century work. The fragmentary preface by Fu Gan to *East Slope's Song Lyrics Annotated* illustrates some of the important changes taking place in the generic status and broadened functions of the song lyric. The preface is packed with self-promotional language that promises that the work that follows is the one sure guide of sufficient discernment for neophyte readers to the uniqueness of Su Shi's song lyrics.

...however the meaning he [Su Shi] lodges [in his song lyrics] is subtle and marvelous, the events they refer to are profound and distant, and each phrase and word has its [textual] source. Therefore, the readers of the world cannot yet easily recognize the surpassing places in his lyrics. They are just like precious and extraordinary treasures that come from a foreign land, their brilliance and colors bedazzle the eyes and everyone stares on them in amazement. But those who can distinguish the quality of these treasures are few. ...然其寄意幽妙，指事深遠，片詞只字皆有根柢，是以世之玩者未易識其佳處。譬猶環奇珍怪之寶，來于異域，光彩眩耀，人人駭矚，而辨質其名物者寡矣。²²

Two important trends can be observed in this brief passage. First, Fu Gan's preface as we have it makes no mention of musical craft or the performative context of the banquet for the song lyric. Instead, Fu Gan stresses the ideas of the author and figurative meaning embedded in the song lyrics of Su Shi, using the two key terms, "to lodge ideas" (*jiyi* 寄意) and "to refer to events" (*zhishi* 指事). During the Northern Song Su Shi's song lyrics were indeed innovative for the way they were linked to events and places in the author's life, often through the use of prose prefaces, and the way they used historical allusions to lodge political or moral criticisms. Fu Gan here praises these written qualities when he compares Su Shi's song lyrics to a "precious and extraordinary treasure that comes from a foreign land." This shows Fu's recognition that Su Shi's song lyrics differed greatly from the mainstream style of the late Northern Song that emphasized musical qualities over authorial persona or density of figurative meaning. Second, Fu Gan also claimed that "each phrase and word has its [textual] source" in Su Shi's song lyrics and implied that his edition would track down these textual sources to provide a model for study by the neophyte song lyric reader-writer.²³ By using this language of textual density and allusions in

²² What has been preserved of this preface is reproduced in Huang Yongnian, ed., *Song Fugan zhu po ci* and Shi Shenghuai 石聲淮 and Tang Lingling 唐玲玲, ed., *Dongpo yuefu bianninan jianzhu* 東坡樂府編年箋注 *Dongpo's Yuefu: Chronologically Arranged and Annotated* (Taipei: Huazheng shuju, 1993): 525-526.

²³ The erudite Southern Song scholar Hong Mai 洪邁 (1123-1202) read Fu Gan's annotated edition of Su Shi's song lyrics and criticized it for what he perceived as its lack of accuracy in identifying the sources of Su Shi's allusions. However, in making such a criticism Hong Mai

reference to the song lyric, Fu Gan directly evokes ideas developed by Huang Tingjian 黃庭堅 (1045-1105) in the 11th century in relation to the reading and writing of *shi* poetry. As Wang Yugen has demonstrated in his recent study, Huang and the group of writers retrospectively designated as the “Jiangxi School of Poetry” placed great emphasis on textual density and allusiveness in poetry and the necessity of broad reading of prior poets in the development of “methods” (*fa* 法) for studying and composing *shi* poetry.²⁴ In the above preface, Fu Gan borrows Huang’s “Jiangxi School” critical language on *shi* poetry to view the song lyric as a genre of sufficient textual density and allusiveness to require annotation. This, in turn, suggests the existence of a market of readers interested in exploring the political and moral “ideas” “lodged” in Su Shi’s song lyrics. In sum, Fu Gan’s preface to his printed collection of Su Shi’s song lyrics goes further in regarding the genre as primarily written “lyrics” rather than performed “tunes” and presupposes an expanded readership interested in an overview of the complete song lyrics of Su Shi and in learning how to write song lyrics in the style of their author.

Similar important changes can be observed in the criticism on Su Shi’s song lyrics from the late Northern Song to the early Southern Song. In his study on the song lyrics of Yan Jidao 晏幾道 (fl. late 11th century), Robert Ashmore describes a period in the development of the song lyric genre when it was primarily identified in terms of criteria of “performance and use” and distinguishes this from a later stage when the genre was defined and debated more self-consciously in terms of formal or textual literary qualities. He argues that, “For participants in the culture of early song lyric, the essential distinctiveness of what we now call *ci* was conceived in these terms of use and performative context rather than in terms of the formal features (metrical, thematic, stylistic, and so on) which were to become the distinguishing characteristics of the two forms from the twelfth century on.”²⁵ During the 11th century there were two polarized views on Su Shi’s song lyrics. The first view, termed “purist or antiquarian” by Ashmore, looked back to the song lyrics of the earlier performative stage and sought in essence to freeze the form. The “purist or antiquarian” view for Ashmore is epitomized by Li Qingzhao 李清照 (1081-?) who criticized the song lyrics of Su Shi and others for their departure from the intrinsic musical qualities and proper diction and themes of the song lyric. In fact, most of the critical comments on Su Shi’s song lyrics preserved from the late Northern Song evaluate them based on the criterion of aesthetic craft and musical pattern, regardless of whether these

demonstrates that an argument about textual sources for song lyrics was considered worth making and that Fu Gan’s “errors” were worth correcting. See the item under “Annotating Books Is Difficult” 注書難 in Hong Mai, *Rongzhai suibi* 容齋隨筆 *The Casual Notes of the Rong Studio* Vol.1 (Shanghai: Shanghai guji chubanshe, 1978): 394.

²⁴ Yugen Wang, *Ten Thousand Scrolls, Reading and Writing in the Poetics of Huang Tingjian and the Late Northern Song* (Cambridge: Harvard University Press, 2011): 41 & 146.

²⁵ See Robert Ashmore, “The Banquet’s Aftermath: Yan Jidao’s *Ci* Poetics and the High Tradition,” *T’oung Pao* No.88 (2002): 217.

evaluations are positive or negative.²⁶ The second view, characterized as “redemptive” by Ashmore, came to the fore during the early 12th century of the Southern Song and saw Su Shi’s song lyrics in a positive light, claiming that they “‘corrected’ certain ethically and aesthetically dangerous tendencies of the form by an infusion of ‘shi-like’ compositional techniques” as well as grounding the compositions in the larger context of an author’s public accomplishments.²⁷

Building on the insights of Ashmore’s study, I would like to extend aspects of his argument to examine the song lyric criticism of the early Southern Song when the “redemptive view” was first articulated and dominated the literary scene. The redemptive view of the song lyric can be best understood as one part of a larger cultural reevaluation of the legacy of the Northern Song and, more specifically, the cultural ethos of Huizong’s reign on the part of Restoration period literati. Critical advocates of the “redemptive” view sought to reshape the historiography of the song lyric genre by projecting a “cleansing” of the genre attributed to Su Shi back into the 11th century. This reshaping process can be seen most clearly in the preface written by Hu Yin 胡寅 (1098-1156) to the song lyric collection of Xiang Ziyin 向子諲 (1085-1152, maternal uncle to Zhang Yuangan). Prior to introducing the song lyrics of the Xiang Ziyin, Hu Yin took a backward glance to the song lyrics of the Northern Song, attributing to Su Shi a revolutionary role in changing the entire field of song lyric writing during his time:

It was not until the emergence of Su [Shi] of Meishan that the preoccupation with silks and perfumes was cleansed away, and the overtly sentimental and elusive feelings discarded. One is [now] able to ascend a height for a distant view, and stroll with one’s head up and sing aloud. One’s untrammelled aspirations and vigorous spirit can soar beyond the dusty world.

及眉山蘇氏，一洗綺羅香澤之態，擺脫綢繆之度，使人登高望遠，舉首高歌，而逸懷豪氣，超然乎塵垢之外。

In this oft-quoted passage, Hu Yin presents Su Shi as having rid the song lyric of its associations with a performative tradition of banquet songs sung by singing girls and abandoned the sentimental tone of the genre. In Hu Yin’s revised historical narrative, Su Shi conveniently marks an absolute break with the past. Rather than take Hu Yin’s claim about Su Shi as an objective description of the Northern Song literary field or even of Su Shi’s song lyric corpus as a whole, as is often done in many literary histories, we can look at them as highly politicized retrospective norms, best understood in the historical context of the restoration period following the collapse of the Northern Song. The late Northern Song would be more accurately described as a

²⁶ For the positive evaluation of Chao Buzhi 晁補之 (1053-1110) recorded in his “Evaluations of Musical Pieces from the Current Dynasty” (*Ping benchao yuezhang* 評本朝樂章) and the critical evaluation of Li Qingzhao 李清照 (1081-?) in her “Discourse on the Song Lyric (*Cilun* 詞論) see Tang Guizhang, ed., *Cihua congbian* Vol. 1, 201-202.

²⁷ Ashmore, 216.

period during which a diversity of song lyric styles coexisted and competed with one another. Song lyrics stressing musical aural qualities and the themes of love and a range of delicate feelings (like many song lyrics by Qin Guan 秦觀 1049-1100, Zhou Bangyan 周邦彥 1056-1121, and Li Qingzhao) circulated at the same time as others which emphasized the persona of the author and moral or political criticisms (like some of Su Shi's song lyrics). Su Shi's song lyrics did indeed offer a strikingly new alternative to song lyric writers of his time, but he clearly did not completely change the style of the genre in his day. In his retrospective history of the song lyric, Hu Yin narrows the diversity of the late Northern Song literary field. In part this attempt to distance Su Shi's song lyrics from a tradition of banquet entertainment may reflect some early Southern Song literati's dissatisfaction with the cultural ethos of Huizong's reign as a whole. At the same time, Hu Yin singles out one particular theme associated with Su Shi's song lyric style for praise. This is the theme of "ascend a height for a distant view." As was stated earlier in the analysis of Su Shi's famous song lyric "The Charms of Niannu," Su Shi imported this trope into his song lyrics in order to express his longing for landscapes associated with admired figures from the historical past. Hence, in Hu Yin's attempt to revise the early history of the song lyric, he also reveals that "sentimental and elusive feelings" have not so much been "cleansed" from the genre, as they have been transferred, from the figure of the singing girl at a banquet to longed for, often lost landscapes.

The redemptive discourse was also used to frame the song lyric collections of literati followers of Su Shi's style in the early Southern Song, as can be seen in the prefaces to the song lyric collections of Ye Mengde and Xiang Ziyin. These prefaces emphasize two overlapping main points. The first point is that the literati writers' adoption of Su Shi's song lyric style clearly marks a boundary between acceptable and unacceptable styles, past and present, within each writer's own corpus and development.²⁸ The prefaces to both writers' collections both describe an aesthetic transformation from flowery craft and over-refinement to austere and direct expression in their song lyrics occurring over the temporal divide marked by the collapse of the Northern Song. For Xiang Ziyin, this transformation is described using the metaphors of flowers and wine.

The retired scholar of Xianglin [Xiang Ziyin] was one who hastened to ascend the hall of Su [Shi] to taste the sliced meat sacrifice. I have observed the way that he withdrew [song lyrics written] "North of the River" to the back [of his collection], while advancing [song lyrics written] "South of the River" to the front. Using a

²⁸ I speak here of Hu Yin's preface to the collection of Xiang Ziyin's song lyrics, entitled *The 'Beside the Wine Bottle' Collection* (*jiubian ji* 酒邊集), and Guan Zhu's to the collection of Ye Mengde's song lyrics, entitled *The Song Lyrics of Stone Forest* (*Shilin ci* 石林詞). Ye's style name (*hao* 號) was *shilin*. For the text of these two prefaces, see Zhang Huimin 張惠民, *Songdai cixue ziliao huibian* 宋代詞學資料彙編 *A Compendium of Materials on the Study of Song Dynasty Song Lyrics* (Shantou: Shantou daxue chubanshe, 1993): 210 and 212 respectively.

heart of withered wood, he dispelled the blossoms and flowers, and drinking from a cup of purified wine, he abandoned the flavor of sweet liquor. If he were not one who, though dyed, did not become stained, how could he have accomplished this?

薌林居士，步趨蘇堂而嚼其馥者也。觀其退江北所作于後，而進江南所作于前，以枯木之心，幻出葩華，酌元酒之尊，而棄醇味，非染而不色，安能及此？

In an apologetic vein, Hu Yin acknowledges that Xiang Ziyin wrote more ornate and flowery banquet song lyrics, but claims that Xiang, using “a heart of withered wood,” was able to transform his song lyric style. In his preface to the song lyrics of Ye Mengde, Guan Zhu 關注 (*jinsshi* 1136) described a similar aesthetic transformation, but one linked with a natural process of personal growth and maturation.

Mr. Ye, Assistant Director of the Right, was honored by the public as a Confucian scholar for his ability in governance and for his literary compositions. With the unspent energy from his brush, he composed to song tunes and these too brought delight to the world. During the Yuanfu reign period [1098-1100] my brother, Shengong, served as the administrator of Zhenjiang while Ye was the commandant of Danxi and obtained a good number of Ye's “little lyrics.” At the time Ye was a young man of vigorous disposition, unable to let go of the feelings in his breast. Savoring his song lyrics, they were subtle and beautiful, possessing the air of the poetry of Wen [Tingyun, 812-866] and Li [Shangyin, 813-858]. But in his later years the flowers fell away and bore fruit. He was able within a style of simplicity and placidness now and again to break forth with the heroic and outstanding. When he combines these traits [of the simple and heroic), his song lyrics are not inferior to the marvels of Jingjie [Tao Yuanming 陶淵明, 365-427] or Dongpo [Su Shi]. How could they even be compared to the run of song lyrics of the recent era?

右丞葉公，以經術文章為世宗儒。翰墨之餘，作為歌調，亦妙天下。元符中，予兄聖功為鎮江掾，公為丹徒尉，得其小詞為多。是時妙齡氣豪，未能忘懷也。味其詞，婉麗綽有溫李之風，晚歲落其華而實之，能于簡淡時出雄杰，合處不減靖節，東坡之妙，豈近世樂府之流哉！

The first half of Guan Zhu's preface stresses how Ye Mengde's song lyrics reflect his maturation, from impetuous youth to the responsibilities of adulthood. Guan Zhu describes this aesthetic change in more specific terms, referring to stylistic traits associated with other poets. The style of his song lyrics written before the collapse of the Northern Song is described as “subtle and beautiful” (*wanli* 婉麗) and is associated with Wen Tingyun and Li Shangyin. The former poet was a writer of musically sophisticated and ornate song lyrics, while the latter poet's works were a major source of quotations for later writers of romantic banquet songs. Ye Mengde's later style, in contrast, combined the “simplicity and placidness” (*jiandan* 簡淡) of Tao Yuanming's poetry with “the heroic and outstanding” (*xiongjie* 雄杰) qualities of Su Shi's very own song lyrics.

The second major point in these prefaces is to overlay the temporal divide between past and present, unacceptable and acceptable song lyric styles, with images of the physical divide of the new border between lost territories and the reestablished

Southern Song. Hence, a second common element to the prefaces of these two Restoration period writers is the prominent place given to geographic borders. The aesthetic transformation of these writers' song lyrics from ornate craft to austere expression over time is mapped onto a geographical change of the border in space between Northern and Southern China. In Xiang Ziyin's song lyric collection this geographical shift is manifested in the self-conscious ordering of his song lyrics. In essence, Xiang Ziyin reversed the standard chronological ordering of his song lyrics to emphasize the priority of his later style linked to Su Shi (song lyrics written "South of the River") over his song lyrics written in an ornate style during Huizong's reign (song lyrics written "North of the River"). The overall sense is that the geographical move south marked a major change in Xiang's song lyric style and an abandonment of early practices. This link between aesthetic transformation and a geographical shift can also be seen in the preface to Ye Mengde's song lyrics. This geographical shift is embedded in an allusion that Guan Zhu uses elsewhere in his preface to describe the moral assuasive power of Ye Mengde's song lyrics. Guan Zhu recounts how on a hot summer day a friend of his was copying out the Ye's song lyrics. Delighted with them, the friend actually felt that Ye's song lyrics helped dispel the oppressive summer heat and quotes a couplet from the *Classic of Poetry* (*Shijing* 詩經) poem "The Mulberry's Tender Leaves" ("Sang Rou" 桑柔, Mao 257) to describe his sense of relief:

When Chen Dezhaoh first got a hold of Ye's song lyrics, he was greatly pleased and brought them out to show me. Wiping away the sweat as I transcribed them, I did not even notice the dispelling of the summer heat. The *Classic of Poetry* states, "Who can hold anything hot?/ Must he not dip it first in water?" The ability of Ye's song lyrics to put people's hearts at ease is exactly like this.

陳德昭始得之；喜甚。出以示余，揮汗而書，不知暑氣之去也。詩云：誰能執熱，逝不以濯。公詞之能慰人心，蓋如此。²⁹

The quoted couplet has been interpreted as likening the ability of the words of a loyal advisor to help a king to avert a catastrophe or the rebellion of his subjects to the way cool water allows one to hold something hot. According to the Mao commentary to the *Classic of Poetry*, the poem is in the voice of the prominent lord, Earl of Rui, Liang Fu 芮伯良父, who criticized King Li of Zhou 周厲王 (878–827 BCE) for blocking the channels for loyal remonstrance and for his reliance on false advisors.³⁰ Historically, King Li is remembered for the way that his violent and oppressive rule led to a rebellion that overturned his rule in 841 BCE. King Li of Zhou was forced to

²⁹ Zhang Huimin, 212.

³⁰ The Mao commentary states, "As for 'Sang Rou,' it is the Earl of Rui's political criticism of King Li" (*Sangrou*, *Ruipo ci Liwang ye*, 桑柔，芮伯刺厲王也). See Chen Huan 陳奂 (1786–1863), annot., *Shi Maoshi zhuan shu* 詩毛氏傳疏 vol. 2 (Shanghai: Shangwu yinshuguan, 1933): 48–54 and Cheng Junying 程俊英 and Jiang Jianyuan 蔣見元, annots., *Shijing zhuxi* 詩經注析 *The Classic of Poetry: Annotated and Analyzed* (Beijing: Zhonghua shuju, 1991): 867–880.

flee into exile to a place called Zhi 隰 in the state of Jin 晉 where he remained until he died. At the same time, King Li was also remembered as the father of King Xuan, a figure celebrated in the *Classic of Poetry* poem “Yangzi and Han.” King Xuan was recorded as leading the restoration of the Zhou dynasty after King Li’s death in exile and moving the Zhou capital to a new location. This narrative of dynastic collapse and restoration and the father-son relationship between King Li and King Xuan has striking and obvious correspondences with the collapse of Huizong’s court, the capture of Emperors Huizong and Qinzong by the Jin army and their “exile” to the north, and the flight of his son Emperor Gaozong to restore the dynasty in the south. Thus, in terms of Ye Mengde’s song lyric style, this allusion to “The Mulberry’s Tender Leaves” links the aesthetic transformation- from ornate craft to direct “heroic and outstanding” expression- and the catastrophic collapse of the Northern Song and the geographical movement of the court and war refugees to the south. In distancing their song lyrics from the performative context of the “banquet” and its associated themes of romantic love and longing, Restoration Era critics and writers overlaid this earlier thematic core with geographic images of the “border.” This allusion also suggests a change in the reading practices of song lyrics in the early Southern Song. Ye Mengde’s song lyrics were being read during the Southern Song for their moral assuasive power, their ability to convey the persona of the author, and their capacity to lodge political criticisms.

Part III: Fragmented Landscapes — Restoration Writers’ Adaptations of Su Shi’s Song Lyric Style

Su Shi’s song lyric style became a popular literary medium among Southern Song literati to describe the experiences of war and displacement during the Restoration Era. The song lyrics of Wang Yining, Zhang Yuangan, and Ye Mengde examined in this section expand upon trends that Su Shi initiated with the song lyric and share distinct formal features with his song lyrics discussed above. First, their song lyrics sentimentalize landscapes. Following a stanzaic structure used in Su Shi’s song lyrics on “imagined travel,” they contrast landscapes in the present with the recollection of a historical moment in that landscape in the past. The transition between stanzas is often marked with terms that liken recalling the past to the process of dreaming and describes a return to a longed-for, but ultimately unattainable, place and time. Second, they display a greater degree of textual density and allusiveness than was common in song lyrics of the 11th century. These poets share a common interest in reworking earlier textual antecedents in the song lyric, focusing on Su Shi’s corpus of song lyrics but also extending to other literary material as well. Third, some of these poets, most notably Zhang Yuangan and Ye Mengde, used the song lyric to voice political protest and remonstrance. Following a precedent set by Su Shi, early Southern Song writers used the genre for the clear purpose of influencing literati public opinion. But with these early Southern Song writers, the impetus for composing song lyrics on longed-

for landscapes had changed from largely displacement due to political exile to displacement due to war and loss of national territory. Thus the same form that Su Shi had developed was used by a wider group of writers than during the late Northern Song and to represent an expanded imaginary community, from a community of like-minded literati to something approaching the country and its territory as a whole. In the hands of early adopters Su Shi's song lyric style became a genre obsessed with border regions that stood as a synecdoche for the lost north. At the same time the emotional tone animating these later works lost much of the philosophical resolution so typical of Su Shi's particular approach to life and took on a stronger tenor of loss and regret. Early Southern Song poets' song lyrics differ greatly from their literary model in the way that tension between the landscape viewed in the present and the poets' vision of the past remains largely unresolved or irreconcilable.

The increased relevance of Su Shi's song lyric style and its focus on geographic tropes is also closely related to the new role these three literati writers took on during the early Southern Song as military commissioners. All three writers had direct or indirect political associations with Li Gang, the first prime minister of Emperor Gaozong's administration. As the manager of Gaozong's court in flight to the south, he actively recruited literati to assist first in the defense of the capital in 1126 and after 1127 in defending border regions. Ruth Mostern has noted that due to the wartime emergency during the early Southern Song the court allowed for the creation of ad hoc defense zones that were "commanded by military commissioners who held extensive powers to handle military affairs, distribute revenues and provisions, and conduct judicial investigations outside of the peacetime system of field administrations."³¹ Each of the three poet's song lyrics reflect the different geographic regions in which they served. Wang Yining and Zhang Yuangan knew each other from 1124 and both responded to the call to defend the capital in 1126, serving under Li Gang in his positions as Judicial Commissioner of the Capital and the Pacification Commissioner of Hebei and Hedong (親征行營使 *Hebeihedonglu xuanfushi* 河北河東路宣撫使), provinces surrounding the capital.³² Both were demoted when Li Gang was removed from these positions after the loss of Kaifeng. Later from 1129-1131 Wang Yining would serve again as Military Commissioner of the Circuit West of the Capital in the area of modern-day Hunan and Hubei which, as a native of Changsha, was also his home region. Zhang Yuangan, on the other hand, resigned from official life and established an important literary network in Fuzhou from 1131 onward. Ye Mengde, as the oldest of the three, had once been a Hanlin academician in Huizong's court during the late Northern Song, but came out of retirement to serve as the Pacification Commissioner of Jiangdong in Jiankang (modern-day Nanjing) for two separate terms

³¹ Ruth Mostern, "Dividing the Realm in Order to Govern" *The Spatial Organization of the Song State (960-1276 CE)* (Cambridge: Harvard University Press, 2011): 229

³² Wang Zhaopeng 王兆鵬, *Liang Song ciren congkao* 兩宋詞人叢考 *Collected Investigations into Song Lyric Writers of the Northern and Southern Song* (Nanjing: Fenghuang chubanshe, 2007): 115 and 340-341.

in 1131-1132 and 1138-1140 to help restore the destroyed city and defend it from being recaptured. Ye Mengde would later be transferred to Fuzhou in 1143-1144 and participate in the literary circle established by Zhang Yuangan over a decade earlier.³³ The common obsession with borders and fragmented landscapes in the song lyrics of these three early Southern Song literati no doubt arose from the wartime emergency and their position as military commissioners on the newly emerging border with the Jin. Below, two representative song lyrics by each writer will be examined to highlight their individual adaptations of the three trends initiated by Su Shi and also to illustrate their common concern for the physical shifts of the border during the Restoration Era.

Wang Yining's song lyrics best demonstrate the degree to which Su Shi's historical personae had become inextricably linked to both his song lyric style and physical traces in his former places of exile by the early Southern Song. The following two song lyrics by Wang Yining evoke the ethos of "transcending sorrow" while in exile so closely associated with the Northern Song poet. They also observe how the memory of Su Shi and other historical figures were tied to and evoked by architectural sites in local landscapes. Both were written about architectural structures built to signify the presence of historical figures in the local landscape to later travelers to the region. The first, composed to the tune "Prelude to the Water Melody" focuses on the Pavilion of Minister Pei constructed in memory of the Tang dynasty minister Pei Xiu 裴休 (788-861) and the second, composed to the tune "Fragrance Fills the Hall" was written on the Evening Clouds Tower but is in fact a literary tour of the Snow Hall constructed by Su Shi during his exile in Huangzhou. The first song lyric was written in 1126 in Changsha, Hunan province where Wang Yining resided following his demotion in the wake of Li Gang's exile in the 8th month of that year. Li Gang was on the road to the capital in the ninth month of 1126 and passed through Changsha along the way to visit Wang Yining. This song lyric is addressed to Li Gang during this visit and compares Li Gang's rallying of troops to defend Kaifeng to two different historical figures.³⁴

水調歌頭
裴公亭懷古

"Prelude to the Water Melody"
"Cherishing the Past" at the Pavilion of Minister Pei

歲晚橘洲上，
老葉舞愁紅。
西山光翠，
依舊影落酒杯中。

The year grows late on Orange Island,³⁵
Withered leaves in a dance of sorrowful red.
Western Mountain, a brilliant emerald green,
As of old, shadows fall into my wine cup.

³³ Wang Zhaopeng, *Liang Song ciren nianpu* 兩宋詞人年譜 *A Chronology of Song Lyric Writers from the Northern and Southern Song* (Taipei: Wenjin chubanshe, 1994): 220-230, 238-260, and 272-278.

³⁴ Wang Zhaopeng, *Liangsong ciren congkao*, pp.118-119.

³⁵ Orange Island is located in the Xiang River, which flows through Changsha.

人在子亭高處，
下望長沙城郭，
獵獵酒簾風，
遠水湛寒碧，
獨釣綠蓑翁。

Someone stands at the height of the pavilion,
Gazing down at Changsha's city walls,
Swish, swish blows the wine banner in the wind.
Distant waters are immersed in a chilly blue sky,
Fishing alone, an old man in a green reed coat.

懷往事，
追昨夢，
轉頭空。
孫郎前日，
豪健頤指五都雄。

Recalling past events,
Pursuing yesterday's dreams,
In a turn of the head, all empty.
Young Sun of former days,
Gallant and vigorous, with a wink he lorded over the five
capitals.³⁶

起擁奇才劍客，
十萬銀戈赤幘，

Rising up he gathered the outstanding talents and s
wordsmen,
One hundred thousand silver daggers and crimson
headscarves,

歌鼓壯軍容。
何似裴相國，
談道老圭峰。³⁷

With song and drums invigorating the army's formation.
How does this compare to Minister Pei,
Discussing the Way, he grew old on Old Scepter Peak?³⁸

The stanzaic division of labor follows closely the patterns established in Su Shi's song lyrics "The Charms of Niannu." The first stanza describes the view of Changsha from the high vantage point of the Pavilion of Minister Pei. The poet's gaze focuses first on an autumnal scene at the end of the day, gradually shifts from the Western Mountain to Changsha's city walls, and finally focuses on an "old man fishing in a green reed coat" in the distance on the Xiang River, which itself flows past Changsha. This movement from conviviality (a banquet in the Pavilion of Minister Pei above the city) to quietude and solitude (a lone fisherman on the river) is repeated in the sequence of historical figures alluded to in the second stanza.

The second stanza begins with a strophe of three short three-character sentences which compare historical reverie to the process of dreaming, evoking the trope of "imagined travel." The final sentence in the first strophe ends with the phrase, "in the turn of a head, all empty," conveying a Buddhist sense of the impermanence of all worldly phenomena. The second and third strophes compose a dramatic scene of Sun

³⁶ Yizhi 頤指 ("with a wink") means to signal or order someone merely with a twitch of one's cheeks. The list of five capitals or five great cities varies from dynasty to dynasty, but for the Three Kingdoms period included Chang'an 長安, Qiao 譙, Xuchang 許昌, Ye 鄴, and Luoyang 洛陽.

³⁷ Tang Guizhang 唐圭璋, *Quan Song ci* 全宋詞 *Complete Song Dynasty Song Lyrics* (Beijing: Zhonghua shuju chubanshe, 1998): 1062. Hereafter, this text will be cited as QSC.

³⁸ Scepter Peak is located in the southeast of Shaanxi province. Pei Xiu composed an epitaph (*beiwén* 碑文) for his acquaintance, the Chan Monk Dinghui 定慧, who was buried on Old Scepter Peak. Pei Xiu's calligraphy was inscribed in stone at the site. This work of calligraphy came to be known as the "Scepter Peak Epitaph" (*Guifeng bei* 圭峰碑).

Quan, ruler of the Kingdom of Wu during the Three Kingdoms period, gathering together “the outstanding talents and swordsmen” in his bid to unite the empire and “lord over the five capitals.” Given the recent events of 1126 when Li Gang gathered forces to defend the besieged capital of Kaifeng, Wang Yining clearly sought to compare Li Gang to Sun Quan. Some sense of the desperation during the siege of Kaifeng and Li Gang’s trust in Wang Yining as his military advisor can be seen in Li Gang’s letter defending Wang Yining from charges concerning his “wild” behavior,

Yining is brave and possesses strategy, but there are some who call him “wild.” Now in the autumn of our difficulties, if one is not wild, then how would they be willing to serve the court, risk stones and arrows in order to achieve merit and fame!

以寧勇而有謀，然人或謂之狂。今日艱難之秋，若非狂者，安肯為朝廷用，冒矢石立功名哉！³⁹

Given the close reliance of Li Gang on officials like Wang Yining during the siege of Kaifeng, it is not difficult to see how Wang Yining would compare Li Gang to the military leader Sun Quan and himself and others as, quite boastfully, the “outstanding talents.” As we shall see in a song lyric by Ye Mengde shortly, historical reveries concerning Sun Quan’s military exploits also often return to his ultimate defeat and the transient nature of his gathering of talented advisors. This theme of transience is implicitly conveyed in the last strophe of Wang Yining’s song lyric through his abrupt comparison of Sun Quan, who failed to unite the empire, to Minister Pei. Pei Xiu rose to the position of prime minister during the reign of the late Tang emperor Xuanzong 宣宗 (r. 847-860) and was known for his political accomplishments, including reforming the system for grain transport by water and controlling the military commandaries. Later he was demoted to become the Military Commissioner (*jiedu shi* 節度使) of Jingnan. While residing in Hunan he immersed himself in the study of Buddhist sutras and built a hut for this purpose on the top of White Deer Mountain 白鹿山. In contrast to the rapid rise and tragic fall of Sun Quan in battle, the culmination of Minister Pei’s career is marked by a kind of transcendence of change. His successes were followed by being politically sidelined and finally his chosen life of Buddhist spiritual cultivation. The phrase comparing the two historical figures “how does this compare” (*hesi* 何似) is somewhat ambiguous in that it does not directly declare which figure’s fate is preferable. However, given that the second stanza mirrors the first stanza in its movement from boisterous camaraderie to quiet spiritual cultivation strongly suggests that Wang Yining was encouraging Li Gang to see himself in the role of Minister Pei. The conclusion to Wang Yining’s “Water Melody” song lyric is not unlike Su Shi’s final summation in

³⁹ See Li Gang’s “A Letter Requesting to Retain Wang Yining” 乞保全王以寧札子 in Wang Ruiming 王瑞明, ed. *Li Gang Quanji* 李綱全集. Vol. 2 (Changsha: Yueli shushe chubanshe, 2004): 618.

his song lyric “The Charms of Niannu” examined above. For Su Shi even the heroic accomplishments of the great Zhou Yu are ultimately transient and dream-like. If anything endures at the end of Wang Yining’s song lyric it is the architectural site of the Pavilion of Minister Pei that continues to remind travelers passing by of his accomplishments. Throughout his song lyric, Wang Yining conveys a distinct pride in the local landscape and historical figures of his native region, Hunan.

A second song lyric composed by Wang Yining in the year 1130 to the tune “Fragrance Fills the Courtyard” also takes the reader on a tour of a local historical site, this time to the architectural landmark of Snow Hall built by Su Shi himself during his exile in Huangzhou. By the time Wang Yining composed this song lyric, he had returned to official service as the Military Commissioner for the Circuit West of the Capitol (*xijing zhizhishi* 西京制置使) serving in the area of modern-day Hubei and Hunan provinces.⁴⁰ After suffering a defeat at the hands of the “roaming bandit” Kong Yanzhou 孔彥舟 in the 8th month of 1130, Wang Yining retreated to Huangzhou, arriving in the 9th month. On the double ninth of this year, Wang ascended to Evening Clouds Tower and composed the following song lyric recalling Su Shi.

滿庭芳
重午登霞樓

“Fragrance Fills the Courtyard”
Ascending Evening Clouds Tower on the Double
Ninth

千古黃州，
雪堂奇勝，
名與赤壁齊高。
竹樓千字，
筆勢壓江濤。
笑問江頭皓月，
應曾照、今古英豪。
菖蒲酒，
兪尊無恙，
聊共訪臨臯。

From ages past in Huangzhou
Snow Hall’s marvelous site
Has reached in fame the height of the Red Cliff.
Like bamboo towers, his myriad words,
The force of his brush quelled river waves.
Laughing, I ask the gleaming moon on the river bank,
How many times has it shown on heroes of the past?
With calamus wine,
In my crater cup there are no worries,
Why not pay a visit together to Lingao?

陶陶。
誰晤對，
粲花吐論，
宮錦紉袍。
借銀濤雪浪，
一洗塵勞。
好在江山如畫，
人易老、雙鬢難葆。

Merrily in my cups
Who can understand and face me?
Brilliant flowers, he spit forth essays,
Palace brocade, I stitched into my long gown.
I’ll borrow these silvery billows and snowy waves
to wash away dust and care.
How fortunate that “river and mountains are like a
painting!”
Growing old comes easy, weeding frosty temples is

⁴⁰ Wang Yining was simultaneously serving as a military advisor to Zhang Jun 張俊 (1086-1154), Pacification Commissioner of Sichuan and Shaanxi (*chuanshaan xuanwushi* 川陝宣撫使) and prefect of Chengdu 成都.

升平代，
憑高望遠，
當賦反離騷。⁴¹

hard.
In that era of peace,
He ascended high, gazed afar,
And fittingly composed his anti-“Li Sao”

This is perhaps the earliest extant song lyric to take Huangzhou and Su Shi as the object of nostalgic recollection and as a site for literary tourism. The fact that Wang speaks of Snow Hall as a “marvelous site” now on equal footing with the Red Cliff testifies to the speed with which Su Shi’s literary persona, sites associated with him, and his song lyric style in particular rose in popularity during the early decades of the Southern Song dynasty. The first stanza opens with a gregarious invitation to join Wang Yining with wine cup in hand to visit the Snow Hall at Lingao. As Ronald Egan has shown Snow Hall was a studio built by Su Shi during a snow storm, the interior of which Su Shi later covered completely with paintings of snow. Su Shi wrote of Snow Hall as a place that he used for meditation and in which he found relief from “vexations and pent-up feelings” associated with his demotion and exile arising from the Crow Terrace Poetry trial.⁴² Just as with the Tang dynasty figure of Minister Pei in Wang’s “Water Melody” song lyric, Wang Yining seeks out a historical figure, here the near contemporary Su Shi, associated with transcending the difficulties of displacement in his “Fragrance Fills the Courtyard” song lyric.

Wang’s use of powerful natural images in this song lyric also evokes the song lyric style of Su Shi. But rather than describe a natural scene, these powerful natural images are used to convey Su Shi’s literary prowess and influence. In the first stanza, the shapes of “bamboo towers” are compared to “myriad words” (*qianzi* 千字), evoking a visual image of Su Shi’s calligraphy (and perhaps his painting too), while the “force of his brush” (*bishi* 筆勢) is said to be able to “quell river waves.” The second stanza continues to pair literary skill with powerful natural images, but turns to focus on Wang Yining’s literary borrowings and reception of Su Shi’s song lyric style. The stanza opens with Wang questioning, “Who can face and understand me,” initiating a literary dialogue with and reminiscence of Su Shi. The natural environment of Huangzhou seems to be imbued with Su Shi’s literary power, as “brilliant flowers spit forth essays.” Wang compares his adaptation of Su Shi’s song lyric style to the actions of “stitching” brocade into his gown and “borrowing” the force of “silvery billows and snowy waves,” here combining verbs of craftsmanship with images from nature. A concrete act of “stitching” Su Shi into Wang’s song lyric immediately follows when Wang includes a direct quotation from the first stanza of Su Shi’s “Charms of Niannu.” This line too compares the sublimity of nature to the ability of human craft to capture it. In a song lyric centered on the process of writing and rewriting an admired predecessor, Wang concludes by describing the act of Su

⁴¹ QSC, vol.2, 1063.

⁴² Ronald Egan, *Word, Image, and Deed in the Life of Su Shi* (Cambridge: Harvard University Press, 1994): 238.

Shi's poetic composition. The last strophe envisions Su Shi "ascending a height, gazing afar," (*pinggao wangyuan* 憑高望遠). We will recall that the early Southern Song critic Hu Yin described the influence of Su Shi's song lyric style with the phrase "One is [now] able to ascend a height for a distant view, and stroll with one's head up and sing aloud." The poetic act of "ascending a height to gaze afar" was associated with the poetic theme of "cherishing the past" (*huaigu* 懷古) in *shi* poetry of the Tang dynasty, precisely the theme that Su Shi introduced into the song lyric genre and that drew the greatest attention of his early Southern Song admirers. Wang imagines Su Shi climbing to a height to compose his "anti-Li Sao." "Li Sao" is of course the famous poem composed by the ancient exiled minister of the Chu state, Qu Yuan, that lamented at great length and with much bitterness that the "world is muddy and only I am pure." Wang suggests that Su Shi's song lyric style "overturned" (*fan* 反) Li Sao's tone of bitter discontent and instead conveyed an attitude of transcending sorrow while in exile, of washing away "dust and care." This final strophe stands as an example of the trope of a "song within a song" that can be seen in the song lyrics of other early Southern Song admirers of Su Shi.

In tracing the revival of Su Shi's song lyric style during this time, Zhang Yuangan's most important adaptation was his use of the song lyric as a letter addressed to like-minded members of a literati community and as a protest work intended to influence public opinion. Only three years senior to the lesser-known Wang Yining, Zhang Yuangan would come to great prominence due to his song lyrics, notably for two epistolary song lyrics both he wrote to the tune "Congratulating the Bridegroom" to protest the court's decision to send two ministers, first Li Gang and later Hu Quan 胡銓 (1102-1180), into exile for opposing the peace negotiation process with the Jin dynasty. In order to influence literati opinion of his day, Zhang developed a song lyric style significantly different from Wang Yining's in outlook and tone. For if Wang Yining was drawn to the theme of "transcending sorrow" found in many of Su Shi's literary works, then Zhang Yuangan took on the role of witness to tragedy and poet-historian often associated with the great Tang dynasty poet Du Fu 杜甫 (712-770).

Zhang Yuangan's connection to the poetry of Su Shi and his 11th century literary circle goes back to Zhang's poetic training during his youth in the late Northern Song. Zhang came of age as a teenager during the years when the court proscribed the writings of the Yuanyou party. Despite such proscriptions against the writings of Su Shi and his colleague Huang Tingjian, Zhang studied poetry with the nephew of Huang Tingjian, Xu Fu 徐府 (1075-1141), at the age of thirteen and later in his twenties participated in a poetry society gatherings attended by Xu Fu and Lu Benzong 呂本中 (1084-1145) among others.⁴³ Lu Benzong is best known as one of the founding

⁴³ Wang Zhaopeng, *Liang Song ciren congkao*, 316-320. One well-documented literary gathering attended by Zhang during his youth was held by the Yuzhang Poetry Society (*Yuzhang shishe* 豫章詩社) in 1111 at Yuzhang. Among the attendees were Xu Fu, Lu Benzong, Xiang Ziyin

poets of the Jiangxi Poetry School and as the author of “Diagram of the Jiangxi Poetry Society’s Ancestors and Branches” (*Jiangxi shishe zongpai tu* 江西詩社宗派圖) that traced the “school” back to Huang Tingjian. In general it can be said that the school emphasized exhaustive study and imitation of the ancients and held that the aspiring poet should create his own individual style by revising the phrases of his poetic predecessors. Du Fu’s complex poetics was also greatly admired by Huang Tingjian and other followers of Huang’s style.⁴⁴ Zhang Yuangan may be among the first poets to have incorporated the Jiangxi school’s concern with dense poetic allusion and rewriting into the song lyric genre. Below I examine two song lyrics composed by Zhang Yuangan in which he weaves allusions to Du Fu and his concern for the fate of the empire within a larger framework of a song lyric-letter addressed to an individual or to the public at large.

Like Wang Yining, Zhang Yuangan was associated with the central figure of Li Gang. Both men served under Li Gang during the defense of Kaifeng in 1126. Following the capture of the city Kaifeng by the Jin army in 1127, Zhang Yuangan then lived for two years in Hangzhou prior to the time it became the new capital of the Southern Song. In the three years between 1127 and 1130 the court of Emperor Gaozong was in active flight from the Jin dynasty invasion. In 1129 while the court was in Yangzhou, a surprise advance by the Jin army forced the court to cross south of the Yangzi River and then to take flight by boat out into the open sea. In the autumn of this year, Zhang Yuangan was also forced to flee Hangzhou to the nearby town of Wuxing. Zhang composed the following song lyric to the tune “*Man Song on Rocks in the Stream*” while he was taking a boat to seek refuge in Wuxing.

石州慢	“ <i>Man song on Rocks in the Stream</i> ”
己酉秋吳興舟中作	Composed on a boat to Wuxing in the autumn of 1129
雨急雲飛，	The rain’s fierceness and the clouds’ flying,
驚散暮鴉，	Startle and scatter the evening crows,
微弄涼月．	Obscuring the cool moon.
誰家疏柳低迷，	Before whose home lost beneath sparse willows,
幾點流螢明滅．	Do these few dots of firefly light flash and go out? ⁴⁵

(Zhang’s uncle), and Su Jian, to whom Su Shi sent his epistolary song lyric to the tune “Joys of Returning to Court” examined above. Ouyang Guang 歐陽光, *Song Yuan Shishe Yanjiu Conggao* 宋元詩社研究叢稿 *Collected Essays on Research into Poetry Societies of the Song and Yuan Dynasties* (Guangzhou: Guangdong gaodeng jiaoyu chubanshe, 1998): 189-194, argues that this poetry society was pivotal in the formation of the Jiangxi School of Poetry. .

⁴⁴ Wang Yugen argues that during the late Northern Song Du Fu was rediscovered and became “the ultimate model of a poet in both critical discourse and practice.” For his thorough going analysis of this process, see Yugen Wang, 32 and 35-64.

⁴⁵ This line alludes to a couplet in Du Fu’s regulated verse poem “Restless Night” 倦夜, “A firefly threading the darkness makes his own light/ Birds at rest on the water call to each other” 暗飛螢自照, 水宿鳥相呼 See Qiu Zhao’ao 仇兆鰲 (1638-1717), *Dushi xiangzhu* 杜詩詳注 *Du Fu’s*

夜帆風使，
滿湖煙水蒼茫，
菰蒲零亂秋聲咽。
夢斷酒醒時，
倚危檣清絕。

In the night my sail is driven by the wind,
The lake full of misty waves, vast,
Autumn sounds rise willy-nilly from bamboo rushes.
The dream is broken as I wake from my cups,
Leaning against the tilting mast in the crisp air.⁴⁶

心折。
長庚光怒，
群盜縱橫，
逆胡猖獗。
欲挽天河，
一洗中原膏血。

The heart is rendered.
Beneath the angry glow of the Long Path star,
Bandit gangs criss-cross the land,
And rebellious barbarians wreak havoc.⁴⁷
I wish I could bend the heavenly river
To wash from the central plains blood and guts.⁴⁸

兩宮何處，
塞垣只隔長江，

Where are the two palaces now?
The frontier ramparts are separated only by the Long River,

唾壺空擊悲歌缺。

In vain he struck the spittoon vase, his sad song unfulfilled.

萬里想龍沙，
泣孤臣吳越。⁴⁹

Ten-thousand miles away I imagine Longsha,
A solitary official weeps in Wu-Yue.⁵⁰

Poetry Copiously Annotated (Beijing: Zhonghua shuju, 1999): 1176. For the English translation see Burton Watson, *The Columbia Book of Chinese Poetry* (New York: Columbia University Press, 1984): 232

⁴⁶ This line alludes to a couplet in Du Fu's regulated verse poem "A Traveler at Night Writes His Thoughts" 旅夜書懷, "Delicate grasses, faint wind on the bank/Stark mast, a lone night boat" 細草微風岸，危檣獨夜舟， See Qiu Zhao'ao, 1228-1229. For the English translation see Burton Watson, 233.

⁴⁷ The appearance of the Long Path star or the Evening star was taken by ancient Chinese astronomers as a sign of war. See Cao Jiping 曹濟平, ed. *Luchuan ci* 蘆川詞 *The Lu River Song Lyrics*. (Shanghai: Shanghai guji chubanshe, 1991): 31.

⁴⁸ This line alludes to a couplet in Du Fu's poem "Washing the War Horses" 洗兵馬詩, "How can a stalwart soldier bend back the heavenly river/ To wash clean the armored troops and use them no more" 安得壯士挽天河，淨洗甲兵長不用。 See Qiu Zhao'ao, 519.

⁴⁹ QSC, vol.2, 1076.

⁵⁰ Here Zhang alludes to the story about Wang Dun found in *New Tales of the World*, Chapter 13 "Virility and Boldness." In this chapter an anecdote is told in which Wang Dun intones a poem by Cao Cao while beating a spittoon with his *ruyi* baton until the mouth of the spittoon was completely in shards. Cao's poem has these lines, "The aged stallion lying in his stall/Still wills to run ten thousand li/ The brave knight in his evening years/ Stouthearted, never will give up" (老驢伏櫪，志在千里/ 烈士暮年，壯心不已). Richard Mather interprets this anecdote to convey "expressions of Wang's resentment at not getting a post at court in 320." See Richard Mather, trans. *Shih-shuo Hsin-yu, A New Account of Tales of the World. Second Edition*. (Ann Arbor: Center for Chinese Studies, University of Michigan, 2002): 323 and Yang Yong, 楊勇, *Shishuo xinyu jiaojian* 世說新語校箋 *A New Account of Tales of the World: Collated and Annotated* (Taipei: Zhengwen shuju, 1981): 455.

The first stanza opens with a description of a boat journey by night, interweaving poetic lines from Du Fu into the description of the natural scene. As Stephen Owen has noted, Du Fu was remembered in the Chinese literary tradition as the “poet historian” due to the way his poetry bore witness to the chaos of the Tang empire in the wake of the An Lushan Rebellion.⁵¹ Furthermore, Charles Hartman has demonstrated how the identification of Du Fu as the “poet historian” was a Song dynasty construction and that by the Southern Song dynasty, Du Fu was further defined by literati of the Restoration Era as a “cosmic survivor” whose poetry could serve as a “guidebook to personal and moral salvation” during this period of national crisis.⁵² In Du Fu’s poetry this “witnessing” often took the form of highly detailed and naturalistic observations of the suffering of people from different levels of society. Other times, Du Fu wrote poems that viewed changes in nature and the cosmos at large as reflections of changes in human society and the empire. One could say that Du Fu could “see the empire in a grain of sand.” Zhang Yuangan creates a foreboding atmosphere in the first stanza of this song lyric precisely through such minute observations of changes in nature that reflect larger disharmony. Two examples of how Zhang Yuangan amplifies the power of his song lyric through references to Du Fu will suffice. Traveling alone on boat during a rainy wind-swept night became standard topoi for Du Fu. Zhang’s observation of “these few dots of firefly light flash and go out” references a couplet from Du Fu’s poem “Restless Night” (*juanye* 倦夜). In Du Fu’s poem and Zhang’s song lyric, the waning light of the isolated fireflies reflects the isolation of people in a time of chaos. At the end of the first stanza Zhang’s “tilting mast” is a clear reference to the opening couplet of Du Fu’s poem “A Traveler at Night Writes His Thoughts” (*Luye shuhuai* 旅夜書懷). In both poems this image symbolized the wavering of the state during the different periods of dynastic collapse each poet witnessed.

In the transition to the second stanza we can see the larger structural outlines of Su Shi’s model for song lyrics on “cherishing the past” and imagined travel. This turn is marked by a moment of “awakening” as the poet’s dream is interrupted at the end of the first stanza. Where the first stanza described a close-up view of physical travel through a natural landscape, the second stanza launches into Zhang’s grand vision of a mythic geography that encompassed the entire territory of the Song empire and into historical reverie. Witnessing how “Bandit gangs criss-cross the land/ And rebellious barbarians wreak havoc,” Zhang wishes that he could “bend the heavenly river/ To wash the central plains of blood and guts.” Here too Zhang has rewritten a line from a Du Fu poem, “Washing the War Horses” (*Xi bingma* 洗兵馬). As we shall see, song lyric writers of the Restoration period often appealed to the power of such mythic actions to restore lost territory. It is important to note Zhang’s reference to the ideal

⁵¹ See Stephen Owen, ed., *An Anthology of Chinese Literature, Beginnings to 1911* (New York: W.W. Norton and Company, 1996): 413.

⁵² See Charles Hartman, “Du Fu and the Song Dynasty Literati,” *CLEAR* 30 (2008): 45.

of the “Central Plains” (*zhongyuan* 中原) region as central to the Song dynasty conceptions of territorial integrity. No sooner does Zhang raise the desire for restored unity with the mention of the “Central Plains,” then he points out the actual fragmented state of the empire. First, he wonders aloud about the fate of the “two palaces,” referring to the abdicated Emperor Huizong and his son Qinzong who were taken captive to the north by the Jin dynasty army following the sacking of Kaifeng. Second, from a seemingly omniscient perspective, Zhang observes the empire divided along a new border line all along the course of the “Long River” or the Yangzi River. This redrawn border line reflected the state of affairs between the Jin and Song when the Jin armies crossed the Yangzi in pursuit of Gaozong’s court in 1129. Thus, from Zhang’s perspective the empire is divided both politically (the unknown status of the former emperor) and territorially (loss of the “central plains” and the Jin army’s crossing of the Yangzi).

The last two strophes amplify Zhang’s sense of frustration through a historical reverie of an unusual musical performance. The “drumming on a spittoon vase” refers to a drum performance on a spittoon by Wang Dun (266-324). Wang Dun was a general of the Eastern Jin dynasty with control over the region around the upper Yangzi delta and was considered a “power to reckon with” at that time. One anecdote records that in frustration at not being granted a position by the Eastern Jin court in 320, he struck a *ruyi* baton against a spittoon until it smashed into pieces, all the while singing a poem by Cao Cao expressing his determination that he “never will give up.” This historical reverie carries a persuasive message to Zhang’s readers not to give up the fight for lost northern territories. The closing image of the lonely poet in the lower Yangzi region of Wu-Yue thinking of the distant northern regions of Longsha reinforces this sense of determination and longing for lost territory.

Unlike Wang Yining and Ye Mengde, who moved between official service and periods of retirement in private life throughout the 1130s, after 1130 Zhang Yuangan resigned from his official posts for good. Instead he established an important literary network in Fuzhou located in modern-day Fujian province. From this region he maintained contact with literati figures from his youth as well as with officials actively engaged in the defense of the reestablished Southern Song court and in policy debates. He and his literary network played the role of what in modern Chinese politics might be called intellectual dissidents or the “faction in the wild” (*zaiye dang* 在野黨). They could be called “dissidents” given that vocal opposition to the peace negotiation process gaining momentum through the two decades of the 1130’s and 1140’s often came with the price of political demotion and exile, particularly under the administration of Qin Gui (1090-1155) during his second tenure from 1138 to his death in 1155. In his study of these two decades, Charles Hartman characterized the period as one of “literary inquisitions” by Qin Gui against opponents to the peace negotiations. Literary expressions of dissents reached a peak in the year 1138 when Gaozong returned to Hangzhou from Jiankang and the future border between the Song and Jin empires began to take shape along the Huai River. In this year and for

several years afterward literati opposition took the form of both official memorials and poems, including two important song lyrics by Zhang Yuangan: one song lyric written to see Li Gang off into exile in 1138 for protesting the peace accord and a second written for Hu Quan who was also sent into exile for his opposition to the peace accord in 1142.⁵³

Below I will examine the second of these two song lyrics composed for Hu Quan. Charles Hartman has provided a thorough-going analysis of the political case of “literary inquisition” against Hu Quan by Qin Gui and the extensive use of allusions in Zhang Yuangan’s song lyric written to him. Therefore I will focus on how Zhang’s epistolary song lyric can be understood as an adaptation of Su Shi’s song lyric style during the early Southern Song and the reception of Zhang’s song lyric by his contemporaries. We will see that in many ways this song lyric bares close comparison to the one Su Shi wrote for his colleague Su Jian in 1094.

賀新郎
送胡邦衡謫新州

“Congratulating the Bridegroom”
Sending off Hu Bangzheng into exile in Xinzhou

夢繞神州路。
悵秋風、連營畫角，

In dreams I wander the roads of the sacred provinces.
Lamenting the autumn wind, the painted war-horns of
the border garrisons,

故宮離黍。
底事崑崙傾砥柱。
九地黃流亂注。

and the imperial palace, over grown and desolate.
What caused Mt. Kun Lun to overturn the Whetstone pillar?
For the Yellow River to course chaotically across the
Nine Provinces?

聚萬落、千村狐兔。

The foxes and hares hold our myriad hamlets, our
thousand villages.

天意從來高難問，

The intentions of Heaven have always been high and hard
to question,

況人情、老易悲如許。

How much more do human feelings turn easily with age to
sorrow

and are hard to tell.⁵⁴

更南浦，
送君去。

Now at the southern shore,
I send you on your way.⁵⁵

⁵³ For a thorough study of the poetry literary inquisitions conducted under Qin Gui’s direction, see Charles Hartman, “The Misfortunes of Poetry Literary Inquisitions under Ch’in Kuei (1090-1155),” *CLEAR* 25 (2003): 25-57.

⁵⁴ This line is a slight expansion of a couplet in Du Fu’s poem “In late spring at Jiangling sending off Ma Daqing who by imperial order departs for Quexia” 暮春江陵送馬大卿公恩命付闕下, “Heaven’s intention is high and hard to question/ Human feelings in age easily turn to sorrow” 天意高難問, 人情老易悲. See Qiu Zhao’ao, 1882.

⁵⁵ This line draws on the wording of a couplet in “The River Earl” (“Hebo” 河伯), one of the “Nine Songs” from the *Lyrics of Chu*, “Eastward you journey, with hands stately folded/Bearing your fair one to the southern shore” 子交手兮東行/ 送美人兮南浦. The early Southern Song commentator to the *Lyrics of Chu*, Hong Xingzu 洪興祖, interprets this line as Qu Yuan

涼生岸柳催殘暑。	A chill rises on the willowed banks, harrying the end of summer,
耿斜河、疏星淡月，	The bright Milky Way scatters the stars and dims the moon,
斷雲微度。	Broken clouds scarcely cross the sky.
萬里江山知何處。	How shall I find you across ten-thousand miles of rivers and mountains?
回首對床夜語。	Remember our night-time talks across the beds--
雁不到、書成誰與。	Who shall carry letters for you now to where even geese cannot fly?
目盡青天懷今古，	Our eyes gaze up to azure heaven, troubled by past and present,
肯兒曹、恩怨相爾汝。	How could we stand to be like those other children, intimate through both love and hate alike?
舉大白，	We raise our wine cups,
聽金縷。 ⁵⁶	And listen to the "Golden Thread" song. ⁵⁷

The first stanza of this song lyric exemplifies the expanded scope of the trope of "imagined travel" found in early Southern Song writers' adaptations of Su Shi's song lyric style. In the opening line Zhang states "in dreams I wander the sacred provinces." As Charles Hartman has pointed out, the term "sacred provinces" derives from an anecdote in *A New Account of Tales of the World* that records the longing of refugees from the Eastern Jin for the recovery of lost northern territories.⁵⁸ Here I would like to point out that the trope of likening "dreaming" to reveries in one's memories in Zhang's song lyrics has expanded from recalling a lover far away in the city (Liu Yong), to a historical figure of the past (Su Shi), to geographic territories as a whole. Rather than a lover far away, territory now plays the role of a

presenting himself as the "fair one" being sent off on his journey to Chu by the River Earl. In the context of Zhang's song lyric, Hu Quan plays the role of Qu Yuan and Zhang the role of the River Earl.

⁵⁶ QSC, vol.2, 1073. For the English translation see Hawkes, 115 and for the Chinese text and Hong Xingzu's commentary see Hong Xingzu, *Chuci buzhu 楚辭補注 Supplementary Commentary on the Lyrics of Chu* (Beijing: Zhonghua shuju chubanshe, 1981): 78.

⁵⁷ Golden Thread Song is an alternate title for the tune "Congratulating the Bridegroom." Here I have slightly modified the translation of Charles Hartman. See Hartman, "The Misfortunes of Poetry Literary Inquisitions under Ch'in Kuei (1090-1155)," 49-50.

⁵⁸ Hartman, "The Misfortunes of Poetry Literary Inquisitions under Ch'in Kuei (1090-1155)," 50. The passage in question occurs in the "Speech and Conversation" (*yanyu* 言語) chapter and recounts how Chancellor Wang Dao tried to boost the spirits of his fellow southern refugees by stating, "We should all unite our strength around the royal house and recover the sacred provinces. To what end do we sit here facing each other like so many 'captives of Chu'?" See Mather, *Shih-shuo Hsin-yu, A New Account of Tales of the World*, 47 and Yang Yong, *Shishuo xinyu jiaojian*, 71.

sentimentalized longed-for other. This is not the only example of Zhang's use of the trope of "imagined travel." Cao Jijian demonstrates in his monograph on the song lyrics of Zhang Yuangan that "Zhang utilized song lyrics recording dreams to pour out the song in his heart" by citing a total of six song lyrics in which Zhang employs tropes such as "dreaming of the Central Plain" (*meng zhongyuan qu* 夢中原去) and other lines of similar phrasing.⁵⁹ The remainder of the first stanza is devoted to describing the depredations imposed on this longed-for territory by the invading Jin armies in grand mythical terms. From a still down-to-earth vision of the abandoned capital, Zhang then leaps to the mythic level by likening dynastic collapse to the collapse of the heavens and primordial floods. He laments that the collapse of Mt. Kunlun has overturned the Whetstone Pillar. The former is a mountain which in Chinese mythology was believed to have a bronze pillar called the "pillar of heaven" (*tianzhu* 天柱) that held up the sky. In one legend recorded in the *Huainanzi* the "pillar of heaven" was broken in a struggle between Gong Gong 共工 and Zhuan Xu 顓頊 for the throne in remote antiquity.⁶⁰ The Whetstone Pillar is another mountain which according to legend the sage ruler Yu bore through in order to tame the flooding Yellow River. This caused the river to split and flow around the mountain, encompassing it and leading to the mountain to be called a "Whetstone Pillar" as it stood in the middle of the river's flow. By a kind of mythical logic, for Zhang the collapse of these two mountain pillars in the present, one holding up the sky and the other dividing the waters of the Yellow River, in turn causes the Yellow River to "course chaotically across the Nine Provinces." The latter geographic term, "Nine Provinces" (*jiudi* 九地 or in other texts *jiuzhou* 九州), refers to the legendary division of the imperial realm into "Nine Provinces" by the sage ruler Yu following his taming of the mythic floods as recorded in the *Tribute of Yu* section in the *Classic of Documents*. Ruth Mostern holds that this text, in legendary terms, initiated "the first territorial structure of the emporium" and by the Song dynasty was considered "the foundational text on the topic of spatial organization and state power."⁶¹ The accumulated literary force of these mythical allusions to foundational texts elevates the concept of territorial integrity embodied in the term "Central Plains" (*zhongyuan* 中原) used in Zhang's earlier song lyric to a higher sacrosanct concept found in the term "sacred provinces" (*shenzhou* 神州).

Zhang's song lyric turns from mythic geography at its opening to become an epistolary song lyric addressed to Hu Quan in its second half. This begins in the end of the first stanza when Zhang contrasts the "intentions of Heaven" (*tianyi* 天意)

⁵⁹ Cao Jijian 曹濟平, *Zhang Yuangan yanjiu* 張元幹詞研究 *Research on the Song Lyrics of Zhang Yuangan* (Jinan: Qi Lu shushe chubanshe, 1993): 91.

⁶⁰ For the legendary battle between Gong Gong and Zhuan Xu that broke the pillar of heaven see John Major, *Heaven and Earth in Early Han Thought: Chapters Three, Four, and Five of the Huainanzi* (Albany: State University of New York Press, 1993): 62-64.

⁶¹ Mostern, 62.

which are hard to question with “human feelings” (*renqing* 人情) that grow sad with age. This is yet another clever re-writing of a line from Du Fu’s poetry by Zhang. More importantly, this allusion allows Zhang to make a very oblique criticism of the current regime’s response to the crisis of dynastic collapse and loss of territory. If it is difficult for Zhang to question the “intentions of Heaven,” the emperor and his court, then he appeals to the “human feelings” of like-minded colleagues like Hu Quan and others. From this point on the song lyric becomes a parting letter to Hu Quan on his journey into exile to Xinzhou. The second stanza can be fruitfully compared to Su Shi’s song lyric sending off both Su Jian and himself into exile in 1094. Su Shi’s song lyric is one of the earliest examples of an epistolary song lyric and established a series of literary moves that Zhang follows. First, there is the use of direct address in both song lyrics, as Zhang addresses Hu Quan as “you” (*jun* 君) in the last strophe of the first stanza, just as Su Shi spoke of “your talent” (*jun cai* 君才) in relation to Su Jian. Second, Zhang contemplates in detail the problem of obstructed communication between himself and Hu Quan caused by vast distances when the latter is sent into exile. The obstructions of landscape (“ten-thousand miles of rivers and mountains”) are contrasted to the intimacy of their past frequent conversations (“night-time talks across the beds”). The distances will be so great that even the proverbial letter-carrying geese of the Chinese literary tradition will not be able to reach Hu Quan. Su Shi stressed the great distance that Su Jian would have to cross by comparing Su Jian’s exile to those of Qu Yuan and Liu Yuxi, with Su Jian’s being the most distant. Third, both poets close their song lyrics with self-referential appeals to the power of song lyrics to bridge gaps in communication across space and time. In Su Shi’s song lyric to Su Jian, Su Shi suggests that exile is not to be lamented, since the two of them will establish a close relationship with the local people and compose song lyrics based on local tunes that will celebrate the region and their contributions to it in the future, just as was done by Qu Yuan and Liu Yuxi. Zhang’s conclusion is by far less sanguine. He offers no explicit consolation to Hu Quan, but simply asks him to raise his wine cup as both of them listen to the “Golden Thread Song,” an alternative title for the tune Zhang composed his song lyric. However, if we interpret this closing direct address as one that Zhang hoped would reach a larger audience of like-minded literati whose “human emotions” he sought to stir up, then I think we can also see Zhang’s use of this trope as an appeal to the song lyric as a genre capable of giving voice to protest and to consolidating a literati community across vast distances.

An examination of the reception of Zhang’s song lyric by his contemporary audience demonstrates the heightened political significance as well as the expanded circulation of song lyrics during the early Southern Song. The most important example of a reader’s response to Zhang Yuangan’s song lyric to Hu Quan, albeit negative, is the reaction of chief councilor Qin Gui. According to the miscellany *The Latter Record of Whipping Away the Dust* (*Huichen lu houlu* 揮塵錄後錄;- published in 1194) by Wang Mingqing 王明清 (1127-?) “several years” (*shunian* 數年, in fact nine years) after Hu Quan was sent into exile by Qin Gui and Zhang composed his song

lyric sending him off, the prime minister heard about the song lyric.⁶² As a result of “offending the powerful minister,” Zhang Yuangan’s name was expunged from the officials’ list, many of his literary works were confiscated, and he was imprisoned in Hangzhou for approximately a year in 1151.⁶³ Such a heavy punishment suggests that Qin Gui took seriously the potential for Zhang’s song lyric to be transmitted wide and far in writing or print and to influence literati public opinion. Interestingly, Zhang Yuangan’s song lyric makes no direct reference to specific policies or administrators involved in implementing them. As we have seen, the “remonstrative” import of many of the song lyrics examined above was encoded in the moments of historical reverie and references to “song as protest” in the closing direct address. By the 1150’s this kind of song lyric was viewed as a potent literary vehicles for “barbed remonstrance” (*fengci* 諷刺). This can be seen in the 1179 preface to the song lyric collection of Zhang Yuangan by Cai Kan 蔡戡 (1141-?), a poet and former prefect of the capital at Lin’an. Cai Kan composed this preface at the request of Zhang Yuangan’s son, Zhang Jing 張靖, who collected his father’s remaining song lyrics. Cai recounts Hu Quan’s political troubles with prime minister Qin Gui and praises the bravery of Zhang’s decision to compose a song lyric seeing him off.

Before his years had reached their prime, [Zhang Yuangan had already] hung up his hat on the Shenwu Gate [i.e., retired], wandered in leisure among springs and rocks, floating along immersed in poetry and wine. He also enjoyed composing “long-and-short lines” [i.e. song lyrics.] His heart of concern for the country and love for his sovereign and his air of indignation at the world and contempt for the wicked were occasionally lodged in his songs. During the peace negotiations of the Shaoxing reign, the current scholar Sir Hu Quan of the Duanming Hall sent up a memorial calling for a sword, desiring to behead the peace negotiators and thereby offended the powerful minister. He was expelled and banished to the seas beyond the southern range. Those who had been his acquaintances and allies during his life, seeking to avoid suspicion and terrified of disaster, only feared that they could not abandon him fast enough. [Zhang] composed a song lyric to send him off. “Subtle yet manifest,” “expressing sorrow without falling into excessive pathos” [Zhang’s song lyrics have] deeply grasped the meaning of “barbed remonstrance” within the Three Hundred Pieces [i.e., the *Classic of Poetry*]. They are unlike the decadent phrases and immoral language of later ages that are suitable only to warn against excess and not to be taken as instruction.

年未強仕，掛冠神武，徜徉泉石，浮湛詩酒。又喜作長短句，其憂國愛君之心，憤世嫉邪之氣，間寓於歌詩。紹興議和，今端明胡公銓志在復仇上書請劍，欲斬議者，得罪權臣，竄謫

⁶² Wang Mingqing, *Huichen lu* 揮塵錄 (Beijing: Zhonghua shuju, 1961): 209.

⁶³ This date is based on the calculations of Cao Jiping. For his survey of the surviving historical evidence see Cao Jiping, *Zhang Yuangan ci yanjiu*, 40.

嶺海，平生親黨，避嫌畏禍，唯恐去之不速。公作長短句送之，微而顯，哀而不傷，深得三百篇諷刺之義。非若後世靡麗之詞，狎邪之語，適足勸淫，不可以訓。⁶⁴

Cai conveys this praise by comparing Zhang's song lyrics to two Confucian canonical texts: the *Classic of Poetry* and the *Spring and Autumn Annals*. The phrase "subtle yet manifest" is used by the *Zuo Commentary* (*Zuozhuan* 左傳) to characterize the subtle but manifest moral commentary that Confucius purportedly lodged in-between the lines of the historical work *Spring and Autumn Annals* (*Chunqiu* 春秋).⁶⁵ "Expressing sorrow without falling into excessive pathos" is a description of the *Classic of Poetry* attributed to Confucius in the *Analects*.⁶⁶ Cai suggests that Zhang's song lyrics possess the same ability to remonstrate the court in a way that falls within the bounds of decorum and yet delivers a clear message. Thus he states that Zhang's lyrics have grasped the meaning of "barbed remonstrance," one of the six aspects of poetry (*Liuyi* 六義) listed in the "Preface to the *Classic of Poetry*" (*Daxu* 大序). These three allusions to the Confucian canon function to elevate the generic status of song lyrics and to recognize the new functions of "barbed remonstrance" that Zhang and others brought to the genre during the early Southern Song. This is the same kind of "redemptive" rhetoric found in Guan Zhu's preface to the song lyric collections of Xiang Ziyan and Ye Mengde analyzed above. As was the case with those two collections, the redemptive discourse seeks to draw the popular genre of the song lyric closer to canonical standards and to distinguish the "right kind" of song lyrics from more "decadent" works presumed to also be in circulation. The preface concludes by stating that Cai Kan arranged to have Zhang's song lyric to Hu Quan placed at the head of the song lyric collection as requested by his son.

Evidence from two later 13th century sources shows that Zhang song lyrics and their authorial-political contexts (*benshi* 本事) continued to circulate widely by means of print. First, Zhang Yuangan's song lyrics are well represented in the 13th century song-lyric anthology, *An Anthology of Surpassingly Fine Song Lyrics Since the Restoration* (*Zhongxing yilai juemiao haoci xuan*, 中興以來絕妙詞選) edited by Huang Sheng 黃昇 with a preface by Hu Defang 胡德方 dated to 1249. Huang Sheng's anthology contains a total of 12 song lyrics by Zhang Yuangan and places Zhang's song lyric for Hu Quan again at the beginning. Significantly, Huang's anthology also contains 31 song lyrics by Su Shi and 41 song lyrics by Xin Qiji 辛棄疾 (1140-1207), giving

⁶⁴ For the Chinese text of Cai Kan's preface see Cao Jiping, ed., *Luchuan Ci* (Shanghai: Shanghai guji chubanshe, 1991): 240-241.

⁶⁵ The passage is found in Duke of Cheng, year 14. See Wang Yunwu 王雲五 ed., *Chunqiu zuozhuan jinzhu jinyi* 春秋左傳今註今譯 *A Modern Commentary and Translation of the Spring and Autumn Annals and the Zuo Commentary* (Taipei: Shangwu yinshuguan, 2000): vol.2, 707.

⁶⁶ See *Analects* 3.20. Here I follow the translation of Edward Slingerland, *Confucius, Analects with Selections from Traditional Commentaries* (Indianapolis: Hackett Publishing Company, 2003): 25. For the Chinese text and commentary, see Jiang Boqian 蔣伯潛, *Sishu duben*, *Lunyu* 四書讀本, 論語 *A Reader for the Four Books: Analects* (Taipei: Qiming shuju, 1994): 37.

significant, though not exclusive, representation to the song lyric style of Su Shi and his later interpreters. Entries in this anthology are arranged by author in chronological order with each author given a brief introduction at the beginning of the selection. Here too, over a century after the song lyric's composition, Zhang's literary legacy is connected to his song lyric "Congratulating the Bridegroom" written to Hu Quan. Huang's biographical entry for Zhang states simply,

Zhang Zhongzong [i.e., Zhang Yuangan] was a native of Sanshan. Upon the completion of the peace treaty in 1138 of the Restoration reign, Hu Zhan'an submitted a memorial asking for the execution of the current prime minister and was exiled to Xinzhou. Zhongzong wrote a song lyric to send him off and later also offended [Qin Gui].⁶⁷

Second, Zhang's "Congratulating the Bridegroom" (1148) song lyric is discussed in a 13th century work of song lyric criticism entitled *Wei Qingzhi's Song Lyric Chats* (*Wei Qingzhi cihua*, 魏慶之詞話) by Wei Qingzhi (13th century). This discussion is found in a section of this book called *The Restoration Song Lyric Chats* (*Zhongxing cihua*, 中興詞話) that was written by the previously mentioned Huang Sheng and may have originally circulated as a separate work.⁶⁸ Including the works discussed here, evidence for the broad circulation and political relevance of Zhang's song lyrics is substantiated by citations and discussion of Zhang's lyrics in contemporary literary miscellanies, two different prefaces to Zhang's song lyric collection written within a generation of Zhang's lifetime, and in at least one song lyric anthology and one work of song lyric criticism from a century later.⁶⁹ In light of the above analysis of Zhang's song lyrics, among the adaptors of Su Shi's song lyric style during the early Southern Song, Zhang Yuangan's song lyrics best represent the expanded use of song lyrics, circulating as personal letters or in print, as vehicles for political remonstrance and to construct communities of like-minded literati.

⁶⁷ Huang Sheng, *Zhongxing yilai juemiao cixuan* in Tang Guizhang 唐圭璋, ed. *Tang Song ren xuan Tang Song ci* 唐宋人選唐宋詞 *Tang and Song Song Lyrics Selected by Tang and Song People* (Shanghai: Shanghai guji chubanshe, 2004): vol.2, 703.

⁶⁸ See Wei Qingzhi, *Wei Qingzhi Cihua*, in Tang Guizhang, ed. *Cihua congbian*, 211.

⁶⁹ The two Southern Song prefaces to Zhang Yuangan's song lyric collection were composed by Cai Kan and Zhang Guang 張廣 (composed 1194). Two contemporary literary miscellanies that discuss Zhang's "Congratulations to the Bridegroom" include Wang Mingqing's *Huichen lu houlu* and Yue Ke's 岳珂 (1183-1242) *Tingshi* 稹史. As noted above, Huang Sheng's *Zhongxing yilai juemiao cixuan* includes "Congratulations to the Bridegroom" and 11 other song lyrics by Zhang, and a brief biographical sketch. Chen Zhensun's catalogue *Zhizhai Shulu Jieti* 直齋書錄解題 lists Zhang's song lyric collection *Luchuan ci* along with a brief biographical sketch. All of these contemporary print sources remark on the way that Zhang incurred the wrath of Qin Gui as a result of Qin hearing about his song lyric for Hu Quan. See Zhang Yuangan, *Luchuan Ci*, 7-8 and 240-242.

The third and final early Southern Song writer discussed in this essay is Ye Mengde. While Ye's song lyrics resemble those of Su Shi on "imagined travel" most closely, the tragic tenor of Ye's song lyrics and the gap between his historical reveries and vision of the present differ greatly from Su Shi and speak to Ye's experience as a transitional figure. Over twenty years senior to Wang Yining and Zhang Yuangan, Ye Mengde's public career spanned the dynastic divide, having served during the last years of the Northern Song in Emperor Huizong's administration and then after the collapse of the Northern Song dynasty followed the court of the last remaining heir to the throne, Emperor Gaozong, in its flight south. At the same time Ye Mengde's early career shared two important similarities to the youth of Zhang Yuangan. First, Ye Mengde's service at Huizong's court was marked by a conflict between his social connections to exiled Yuanyou officials or their relatives and his position in Huizong's "New Laws" administration. Ye Mengde came to age as a member of the scholar-official class during the return of the New Laws administration to power and at the height of the proscriptions against the opposition "Yuanyou" party, gaining his *jinshi* in 1097 at the age of 21. As the nephew of one of Su Shi's younger protégés, Chao Buzhi, Ye maintained close connections with the Chao family as well as with one of Su Shi's sons, Su Guo 蘇過 (1072-1123), who had accompanied his aging father into exile on Hainan island.⁷⁰ While serving during the reigns of emperors Zhezong and Huizong, Ye Mengde briefly advanced to as high a position as Hanlin Academician in 1108, but chaffed under the near-dictatorial control of Prime Minister Cai Jing 蔡京 (1045-1126). After submitting memorials advocating the relaxation of the proscriptions against the Yuanyou opposition in 1107 and warning against assigning the eunuch Tong Guan 童貫 (?-1126) as a general in the Song army in 1108, Ye Mengde was demoted and served in provincial posts or lived as a private citizen in his home area of Bian Shan 卞山 (modern-day Suzhou 蘇州) for the next fifteen years.⁷¹ He remained sidelined there until he was recalled at the age of 50 by Emperor Gaozong's court in 1127 to help shore up the embattled country and dynasty.

Second, like Zhang Yuangan, Ye also showed an early interest in composing song lyrics. Ye began writing *manci* song lyrics upon his early journeys to the Northern Song capital of Kaifeng, recalling the connection to youth in the city and song lyrics found in the works of Liu Yong.⁷² However, judging from available evidence, it appears that it was only in the later years of Ye Mengde's life during an era of dynastic collapse and geographic fragmentation that he began to adapt the song lyric

⁷⁰ Wang Zhaopeng, *Liangsong ciren nianpu*, 136, 173.

⁷¹ Ibid., 35-68.

⁷² Wang Zhaopeng 王兆鵬. *Liangsong ciren nianpu*, 136-137, 140. Ye Mengde's earliest datable song lyric is a *manci* written to the tune "Congratulating the Bridegroom" (He Xinlang 賀新郎) in 1094 on the occasion of Ye Mengde's first journey to take the official examination in Kaifeng. This early *manci* bears a much closer resemblance to the song lyrics of Liu Yong and Zhou Bangyan than those of Su Shi.

style of Su Shi. His most important service during the early Southern Song was two tours in Jiankang: first, from 1131 to 1132 at the age of 45 and then again seven years later from 1138 to 1142 at the age of 60. During these time periods he served as Pacification Commissioner for the Circuit East of the River (*jiangdong anfu zhizhi dashi* 江東安撫制置大使) and magistrate of Jiankang. Similar to Wang Yining, Ye Mengde held a military post responsible for the defense of the new frontier zone that had emerged along the length of the Huai River in central China. It was during this time that Ye began incorporating elements of Su Shi's song lyric style in his lyrics on the cities of Jiankang 建康 and Shouyang 壽陽 that had recently become border-towns on the Huai-nan frontier. Given the close friendship between Zhang Yuangan and Ye Mengde later in life, one can hypothesize that Zhang's song lyrics may have inspired Ye Mengde's slightly later works. Ye became acquainted with Zhang Yuangan personally during his last official posting to Fuzhou in 1142-1144. During this time Ye exchanged matching-rhyme song lyrics with him at a literary gathering hosted by Zhang. When Ye died in 1148 Zhang wrote an eulogy (*jiwen* 祭文) in mourning. Ye's close association with Zhang's literary circle late in his life, Zhang's esteem for Ye, and the broad circulation of Zhang's song lyrics, all strongly suggest that Ye Mengde was aware of Zhang's striking song lyrics of protest and experimentation with Su Shi's song lyric style

Ye Mengde clearly drew on elements of Su Shi's song lyric style to describe the frontier region and to express his longing for lost landscapes. Traces of this style are apparent in the following song lyric, set to the tune "The Charms of Niannu," written upon Ye Mengde's return to Jiankang in 1138 after a six-year absence while in retirement. The song lyric is an homage to Su Shi's song lyrics, following the exact same rhyme words and written to the same tune pattern as Su Shi's "The Charms of Niannu" recalling the Battle of the Red Cliff, examined above. Adapting Su Shi's trope of "imagined travel," Ye's two stanza *manci* alternates from a view of the fragmented borderland in the present to an imagined journey to the past and vision of the city as the capital and cultural center of the 3rd century CE Kingdom of Wu. In this song lyric Ye Mengde recalls the founders of the Wu state during the Three Kingdoms period in their prime, the young Sun Ce 孫策 (175-200) and his younger brother Sun Quan 孫權 (182-252). In fact, Ye Mengde evokes the Three Kingdoms period from the very beginning of the song lyric by referring to the city of Jiankang as Wu. In the first strophe of the opening stanza, Ye Mengde describes his return to the city of Jiankang as he might describe the reunion with a longed-for-lover.

念奴嬌

"The Charms of Niannu"

雲峰橫起，
障吳關三面，

Cloudy peaks soar upward,
A screen enclosing Wu on three sides,

真成尤物。

倒卷回潮目盡處，

秋水黏天無壁。

綠鬢人歸，

如今雖在，

空有千莖雪。

追尋如夢，

滿餘詩句猶杰。

Truly making it an enticing object!⁷³

The returning tide rolls in where the eye's gaze extinguishes,
Autumn waves merge seamlessly with the sky.

I left here for home with jet black hair

And though here again now,

In vain I've grown a thousand roots of snow.⁷⁴

Pursuing the past is like a dream,

Brimming with poetic lines, it returns to life!

聞道尊酒登臨，

孫郎終古恨，

長歌時發。

萬里雲屯瓜步晚，

It is said that with wine cup he climbed here,

Young Sun's regret has continued through the ages,⁷⁵

Voiced in long songs over and again.

Clouds gather from ten thousand miles as it grows

late on Mt. Guabu,⁷⁶

落日旌旗明滅。

鼓吹風高，

畫船遙想，

一笑吞窮髮。

當時曾照，

更誰重問山月。⁷⁸

In the setting sun flags flash then vanish.

With drums and pipes in the high winds,

From my painted boat I distantly imagine,

In a single laugh swallowing up the "bald and barren" north!⁷⁷

At that time it shined from above,

Who since then has asked again about moon and mountain?

The first stanza describes Ye Mengde's vision of the landscape of Jiankang in the present as a fragmented borderland. The term "an enticing object" (*youwu* 尤物) traditionally referred to a dangerously seductive woman, here enclosed within a

⁷³ Ye Mengde here refers to the long-held view that Jiankang's geographic position afforded it natural protection because of the flowing of the Yangzi on the west and north sides of the city and mountains on the north, east, and south sides. See Qiu Juxian 丘菊賢. *Zhonghua ducheng yaolan* 中華都城要覽 *An Overview of the Essentials Regarding China's Capital Cities* (Kaifeng: Henan daxue chubanshe, 1989): 258-267.

⁷⁴ The contrast between "jet black hair" and "a thousand roots of snow" refers to passage of time of six intervening years between Ye's two postings in Jiankang.

⁷⁵ During the Three Kingdoms period, Sun Quan lay claim to the Wu area, fixed his capital at the city of Jiankang, and declared himself emperor in the year 220. See Chen Qiaoyi 陳橋驛, *Zhongguo qi da gudu* 中國七大古都 *China's Seven Great Ancient Capitals* (Beijing: Zhongguo qingnian chubanshe, 1991): 186.

⁷⁶ Mt. Guabu was the site of battles both to defend the kingdom of Wu, by Sun Ce, as well as attempts to invade the south, such as an attack on the Song dynasty by the Northern Wei ruler Taiwu Di in 450.

⁷⁷ This characterization of the lost northern territories draws on a quotation from chapter one, "A Free and Easy Wandering" (*xiaoyao you* 逍遙遊), of the *Zhuang Zi* 莊子. See Burton Watson, *Chuang Tzu: Basic Writings*.³¹

⁷⁸ QSC vol. 2, 768. For the dating to Ye's second tour in Jiankang as coming between 1138-1142 see Wang Zhaopeng, *Liang Song ciren nianpu*, 259.

three-sided screen (*pingzhang* 屏障). In describing Jiankang and the surrounding mountainous landscape as a lover enclosed within a screen Ye Mengde evokes the language of romance typical of early song lyrics such as those collected in the *Collection Among the Flowers* (*Huajian ji* 花間集). Like Zhang Yuangan's dream wanderings to the "central provinces" or the "sacred provinces," Ye's description of Jiankang in terms that liken it to a beautiful courtesan lover effectively sentimentalizes the city landscape. At the same time that he describes the city as a longed for object/lover, Ye also uses the conceit of a screen to describe Jiankang's strategic geographic location. Surrounded on three sides by the Ningzheng range (to the north, east, and south), the city has been described since the 3rd century as "a coiled-up dragon and crouching tiger" (*Longpan huju*, 龍蟠虎踞). Although these natural barriers protect the city, they also fragment it, divide it from the larger landscape, and define the city as a borderland. As Ye Mengde gazes to the west and north to the Yangzi River, the "autumn waters" bring a somber tone to his description of the city. Just as the city seems to be aging, so too has Ye Mengde. Having returned after a six-year absence he has in his late years "grown a thousand roots of snow" on his head. In the final strophe Ye directly evokes the trope of "imagined travel" by likening the process of recalling the past to a dream. Facing a devastated city and an aging body, Ye Mengde seeks to recenter or even to resurrect Jiankang by recourse to an earlier vision of the city, "Brimming with poetic lines, it returns to life!"

The second stanza recalls the historical past of Jiankang when it was the cultural center and political capital of the Kingdom of Wu. As is common in song lyrics on "imagined travel" by writers of the Northern Song like Liu Yong and Su Shi, the return to the past is also a nostalgic return to youth. The southeastern regions of the lower Yangzi delta were controlled by the Wu kingdom and the second ruler Sun Quan would establish Jiankang as a dynastic capital in the south for the first time in Chinese history. The "regret" of "young Sun," though unstated, surely refers to the thwarted ambitions of the Sun family to outwit their opponents from the competing Wei and Shu kingdoms and expand their territory into the north and west. In the light of Wang Yining's "Prelude to the Water Tune" composed for Li Gang that compared the latter to the great general Sun Quan, it is extremely tempting to hypothesize that Ye Mengde here too uses Sun Quan as a historical analogy for the attempts of Li Gang to defend the capital, Kaifeng, and his "eternal regrets" at having failed to do so. In the second and third strophes of the second stanza the poet turns the focus of his gaze again to the north of the city. Ye Mengde calls our attention to the clouds gathering on Mount Guabu, a mountain located immediately north of the Yangzi River, beyond the city of Jiankang and its protective screen. Historically, Mt. Guabu was a strategic observation post from which the armies advancing from the north could be viewed and from which the south could be defended during the Wu kingdom and subsequent times. Given the lack of personal pronouns in the second and third strophes, these lines describing the musical performance of pipe and drums and the view from Mt. Guabu could be interpreted as occurring in the past or the present, in

the voice of Ye Mengde or of Sun Quan. Indeed, the classical Chinese even allows for both voices to be present at the same time. Hence, we may read these lines as Ye Mengde's voice merging with that of the 3rd century general Sun Quan (perhaps a figure standing for Li Gang) in their common hope to "in a single laugh swallow up the 'bald and barren north!'" Ye draws this last allusion from the *Zhuangzi*, where the text describes the fantastic flight of the mythical Peng bird as it soars from the "bald and barren north" to the southern sea. Like Zhang Yuangan's song lyric, Ye appeals to a mythical leap in order to restore lost territories, indicating the large gap between the present geographic reality of divided territory and the longed for fantasy of a quick or instantaneous recovery of the north.

The fourth and final strophe is in the form of a direct address and rhetorical question to the audience of the song lyric, similar to Su Shi's song lyrics on "imagined travel." However, in contrast to Su Shi's bold declaration "Who says past and present are divided," for Ye Mengde there is still a gap between past and present, a break between the border city of Jiankang in the present and his vision of it as a capital in the past. When Ye Mengde asks his audience, "Who since then [Sun Quan's time] has asked about moon and mountain?" he implies that no one in the present has yet realized again the geographic and cultural potential of Jiankang's "moon and mountain."

A second song lyric Ye Mengde composed on "imagined travel" in 1140 finds him in the city of Shouyang 壽陽, 180 km north of Jiankang. This city was located on the banks of the Huai River, the official border between the Jin and Song empires as set down in a peace treaty of 1138. In 1140 the Jin prince and general, Wuzhu 兀术 (?-1148), broke the peace treaty that had established this border, and advanced toward the Huai River near Shunchang 順昌. In his position as Pacification Commissioner of Jiangdong, Ye Mengde participated in preparing the defense against the Jin army's second invasion.⁷⁹ This song lyric was also written just two years after Emperor Gaozong decreed Hangzhou to be the official capital and demoted Jiankang to the status of "Reserve Capital." Just prior to the military confrontation between the Song and Jin armies, Ye Mengde composed the following *manci* to the tune of "Ganzhou in Eight Rhymes" (*Basheng Ganzhou* 八聲甘州), another *manci* tune title closely associated with Su Shi. The structure of this *manci* also follows a similar pattern to many of Su Shi's song lyrics on "imagined travel," though here in reversed order. The first stanza recalls figures from the historical past associated with the city of Shouyang, while the second stanza returns to a view of the landscape in the present. Ye Mengde focuses on two historical associations of Shouyang. First, he notes that Shouyang was once the capital of the ancient kingdom of Chu. Second and even more importantly, he recalls Shouyang as the site of the Battle at the Fei River during the Eastern Jin dynasty in 383 CE. Looking at the Huai River as it weaves around the city of Shouyang on the eve of battle inspires Ye Mengde's historical reverie.

⁷⁹ Wang Zhaopeng, *Liang Song ciren nianpu*, 253-257.

八聲甘州
故都迷岸草，
依然繞孤城、望長淮。

想烏衣年少，
芝蘭秀發，⁸⁰
戈戟雲橫。
坐看驕兵南渡，

沸浪駭奔鯨。⁸¹
轉盼東流水，
一顧功成。

千載八公山下，

尚斷崖草木，

遙擁崢嶸。
漫雲濤吞吐，
無處問豪英。
空成今古、信勞生，
何事愴遺情、笑我來。

東山老，
可堪歲晚，
獨聽桓箏。⁸²

“Eight Rhymes to Ganzhou”

The ancient capital is lost in the grasses on the bank,
Gazing at the long Huai River, still winding around
the lonely city.

I imagine the youth of Rook Robe Lane:
Fragrant orchids in their first bloom,
Spears arrayed as in rows of clouds.
Sitting [Xie An] watched the proud armies ferry to the
South,

As roiling waves startled the charging whales.
Turning his eyes to the eastward flowing waters,
In the turn of a head, the battle was won.

For a thousand years the rivers beneath Bagong
Mountain,
Even now the grass and trees on their fragmented
banks,
Reaching far embrace these towering peaks.
Boundless mist, swallowed and spit forth by the waves,
Leaving nowhere to ask about great heroes.
Truly their toils in vain have become history,
Laughing at myself, why am I saddened by these
lingering feelings?

The old man of Eastern Mountain,
Can one bear that in his waning years,
He alone listens to Huan Yi's zither tune?

In the first stanza, Ye stresses the precarious situation of Shouyang in the present, hinted at by the verb “lost” (*mi* 迷) in the first strophe and further reinforced when he describes Shouyang as “lonely” despite the fact that the Huai River girds it like a border in the second strophe. In a series of three four character lines led by the phrase, “I think” or “I imagine” (*xiang* 想) Ye Mengde recalls the Battle of Fei River (*Feishui zhi*

⁸⁰ “Rook Robe Lane” refers to a district in the capital city of the Eastern Jin dynasty, Jiankang, where the powerful Wang and Xie clans lived, including Xie An's family and descendents. I have borrowed the translation of this place name from Stephen Owen, “Meditation on the Past,” 423. On this site in Jiankang, see Mather, *Shih-shuo Hsin-yu, A New Account of Tales of the World*, 194-195.

⁸¹ The metaphor of “charging whales” for the invading army of Fu Jian comes from a *shi* poem by Xie Tiao 謝朓 (464-499), a descendent of Xie An. The poem “A Poem on Bagong Mountain Written to Editorial Director Wang” (*He Wang zhuzuo Bagong shan shi* 和王著作八公山詩) appears in the literary anthology *Wenxuan* 文選. See Chen Hongtian 陳宏天 et.al., eds., *Zhaoming Wenxuan yizhu* 昭明文選譯注, 6 vols. (Changchun: Jilin wenshi chubanshe, 1992): IV, 1052-1055.

⁸² QSC, vol.2, 766. For the dating to 1140 see Wang Zhaopeng, *Liang Song ciren nianpu*, 253.

zhan 淝水之戰). Dynastic histories (*History of the Jin*, *Jinshu* 晉書) and near-contemporary works to the battle (*A New Account of Tales of the World* or *Shishuo xinyu* 世說新語, compiled around 430 CE), depict this battle as decisive in preserving the existence of the Eastern Jin from incursions from the competing Former Qin 前秦 (351-394) state to the north.⁸³ More importantly for Ye Mengde, the battle of the Fei River is framed as a nostalgic return to a time of youth and a celebration of the centrality of the city of Jiankang and its political/cultural elite of the 4th century. All of these ideas are evoked by the phrase, “the youth of Rook Robe Lane,” a prominent lane in the city of Jiankang where the political and cultural elite of the Eastern Jin resided, including key figures of the Xie clan leading the defense at the Battle at the Fei River in 383 CE. The youth and martial vigor of the Xie brothers are conveyed through a series of striking images linked by a flowing process of free association, with images of slender delicate orchids “in their first bloom” transformed into row upon row of sharp spears standing like “clouds.” Similarly, the Battle at the Fei River is described in a set of water metaphors, with the invading army of Fu Jian 苻堅 (reigned 357-385) changed into “charging whales” and the successful defensive efforts of the Xie brothers conflated with the power of the river itself as “roiling waves.” The historical memory of this victory and successful defense of a river border is the collective effort through which Ye Mengde sought to connect with his reading or listening audience.

His return to a view of the landscape in the present in the second stanza by contrast, stresses a sense of being geographically cut-off and having one’s view of the landscape blocked. The Fei River is a tributary of the Huai River, flowing just south of it and eventually turning north and merging with the Huai at Bagong Mountain (*Bagong shan* 八公山), located in between the two rivers. The Huai River appears to both protect the city of Shouyang, but also obscures any attempt to gain an all-encompassing panoramic view. Given the close connection Ye Mengde makes between “gazing” at the landscape and constructing connections with colleagues in the present and like-minded figures of the past, these repeated evocations of a fragmented and obstructed landscape seem to represent Ye’s sense of displacement from the north and frustrated inability to regain a “vision” of the whole.

The closing two strophes of Ye Mengde’s *manci* form a direct address to his literati audience in the form of a song within a song. Here Ye makes a second allusion to the Xie family in the 4th century, referring to a historical musical performance given by the zither player Huan Yi 桓伊 (died 392) to the literatus-general Xie An who led the defense of the south at the Battle at the Fei River. Huan Yi, a talented musician on flute and zither, sings a song for Xie An at a banquet held by Emperor Xiaowu 孝武帝 (reigned 373-397 CE) of the Eastern Jin. Xie An, also known as “the old man of the Eastern Mountain” for his place of retirement in Eastern Mountain (located in

⁸³ See *The Chronicle of Fu Chien: A Case of Exemplary History*, translated and annotated with prolegomena by Michael C. Rogers, on how the battle was “processed” by official historians to convey a message to their imperial patron.

modern-day Zhejiang province), had fallen victim to the slander of princes at the court and fallen out of favor with Emperor Xiaowu. Huan performed a song to the accompaniment of his zither that criticized the emperor for having so quickly forgotten Xie An's defense of the country at the river border, moving Xie An to tears of recognition and eliciting from the emperor a "shamed appearance" (*kuise* 愧色).⁸⁴ Within this historical musical performance, there are three key actors: the musician, the literatus-general, and the emperor. Through this allusion, Ye Mengde suggests that there is a bond of solidarity between himself as the song lyric performer and his implied audience of like-minded literati, just as there was between the performer Huan Yi and his audience Xie An, both of whom fought in the battle of the Fei River. However, unlike the story of Huan Yi's performance where the emperor is present and chastised by Huan's remonstrance, Ye states that Xie An "alone" listens to Huan Yi's song. Thus a double division unites the group of Southern Song literati addressed in Ye Mengde's closing strophe. They share a common displacement from the occupied territories in the north and, in their commitment to recovering the north, also share a common sense of disenchantment with a court avid in its pursuit of the reassertion of internal consolidation and control, deaf to songs of remonstrance.

Conclusion

Through this examination of the adaptation of Su Shi's song lyric style by three early Southern Song literati we can observe different responses to redrawn borders and the court's wartime policy during the Restoration Era. Each writer established a different kind of intellectual "dialogue" with Su Shi's literary legacy in their song lyrics. Wang Yining drew on the spirit of philosophical adaptation to adversity and the displacement of exile found in many of Su Shi's literary works. In terms of geography, Wang's song lyrics focused on the way historical figures of the past left their mark on local landscapes by building structures that would signify their presence to later travelers. His song lyrics stressed the presence of national figures, such as the Tang minister Pei Xiu or the Northern Song literatus Su Shi, in the local Hunan landscape, a place that was both his native home as well as his place of service as a military commissioner. Zhang Yuangan, by contrast, took a much broader view of the fragmented state of the empire. He drew as much on the poetry of Du Fu as he did the song lyrics of Su Shi in fashioning himself as the poet-historian of the Restoration Era and witness to the tragedy of dynastic collapse. In Zhang's song lyrics, we see the shift of the border with the Jin to the Yangzi River. He magnified the sense of crisis by pushing his descriptions of geography to a grand mythic level, lamenting the loss of the "Central Plain" or "sacred provinces." Ye Mengde's song

⁸⁴ For the story of Huan Yi's musical performance before Emperor Xiaowu and Xie An, see Fang Xuanling 房玄齡 (578-648), *Jin shu* 晉書 *History of the Jin Dynasty* (Beijing: Zhonghua shuju, 1974): 2118-2119 and Richard Mather, *Shih-shuo Hsin-yu, A New Account of Tales of the World*, 569.

lyrics focused on two important cities, Jiankang and Shouyang, both located on the border of the Huainan region in-between the Yangzi and Huai Rivers, the area he rebuilt and defended as Pacification Commissioner. In Ye's song lyrics, we see the border shift again south to the Huai River. Although Ye recalls the past glories of these two cities and the Three Kingdoms or Six Dynasties figures who defended them, his historical reveries and vision of the present are irreconcilable. The Huainan landscape of the present is broken-up and lost in the mists and the court is presented as unreceptive to his remonstrative songs.

While each writer's song lyrics have a unique focus, as a group their works reflect a common interest and literary trend in reviving and adapting Su Shi's song lyric style during the first half of the 12th century. This paper has demonstrated that while Su Shi's bold song lyric style was not very well received during the late Northern Song, it became increasingly popular as a literary model during the early Southern Song starting as early as the 1130's and 1140's, especially among those scholar-officials tasked with the defense of the frontier regions that emerged following the loss of the north to the Jurchen Jin dynasty. These men formed a coherent group of literati with a common outlook, including their opposition to the 1138 peace treaty between the Song and Jin dynasties. This transitional generation of early Southern Song literati effectively established Su Shi's song lyric style as a viable and acceptable model for future literati, among a range of different available styles that coalesced around the works of major Northern Song writers. They followed Su Shi's innovations of incorporating the theme of "cherishing the past" and his trope of "imagined travel" into the song lyric genre, using the song lyric as a vehicle for both nostalgic reflection and direct or indirect political remonstrance. The prefaces to the song lyric collections of Ye Mengde and Zhang Yuangan demonstrate that literati sought out canonical precedents for their use of song lyrics as a form of "barbed remonstrance" and in the process distanced the song lyric from the realm of popular culture and drew it closer to canonical Confucian standards. At the same time, their song lyrics still served as a form of elevated form of collegial discourse and entertainment, as evidenced by Zhang's famous epistolary song lyrics to Li Gang and Hu Quan, as well as Ye Mengde and Wang Yining's participation in the exchange of matching-rhyme song lyrics in Zhang's literary circle in Fuzhou. These poetic letters and banquet songs served the long-term functions of solidifying literati networks across the distances of the contracted Southern Song empire, just as Huang Sheng's anthology allowed for the continuity of this song lyric tradition in print across a century of different emperors' reigns. The song lyrics by these early southern Song literati represent an important stage in the genre's development. Based on the literary legacy of Su Shi's song lyrics, early Southern Song writers adapted the song lyric to the new functions of longing for landscape and remonstrating the court while continuing to maintain traditional functions too, constantly moving back and forth, always somewhere between the banquet and the border.